A

<u>Winter Project Report</u>

on

"A study on impact and consequences of selective marketing on gen z (1997-2012) for gaming industry in Surat city"

Submitted by

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Under the guidance of

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DECLARATION:

I, Yashi Desai, declare that this Winter Training Report titled "**A Study on the Impact and Consequences of Selective Marketing on Gen Z for the Gaming Industry in Surat City**" is a result of my own efforts and has been carried out under the supervision of Prof. Dr. Mehul Ganjawala, in partial fulfilment of the requirements for the Bachelors of Business Administration at D.R. & R.B. Patel Commerce College & Navnirman Institute of Management affiliated to Veer Narmad South Gujarat University. I affirm that this work is original and has not been submitted for any other degree or award. I have made full use of available resources, including books, articles, and internet sources, and have provided proper citations for all the references used.

Date:

Place: Surat, Gujarat, India

Signature

[Yashi Desai]

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

This research explores the impact and consequences of selective marketing on Gen Z gamers in Surat City, focusing on how targeted marketing strategies affect their gaming preferences, purchasing behavior, and engagement with gaming content. With the gaming industry becoming increasingly competitive, understanding the influence of personalized advertising and selective marketing is essential for game developers and marketers aiming to capture the attention of this highly influential demographic.

The study employed a questionnaire-based survey to collect data from 103 Gen Z respondents, examining factors such as the time spent gaming, preferred platforms, and the influence of selective marketing in shaping gaming habits. The results show that selective marketing, especially through social media influencers, memes, and viral content, significantly impacts gamers' decisions. However, the data also reveals that peer influence plays a more substantial role than advertisements in determining which games are played, suggesting that word-of-mouth and social validation are key drivers for Gen Z.

Further analysis of the findings indicates that while most respondents engage in casual gaming (less than 5 hours per week), a smaller group dedicates more time to gaming, with males generally spending more time on gaming than females. The study also explores the broader consequences of selective marketing, including its potential to create stronger connections with gaming communities and shape perceptions of games as "socially acceptable" within peer groups.

In conclusion, the research underscores the importance of authentic, community-focused, and peer-influenced marketing strategies for engaging Gen Z gamers. It suggests that gaming companies need to adapt their marketing approaches to align with the social and cultural preferences of this demographic, ensuring that campaigns resonate with their values and create lasting engagement. The findings provide valuable insights into how selective marketing can be optimized to attract and retain Gen Z customers in an ever-evolving gaming market.

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Chapter 1:

Introduction

1.1 Introduction:

i. As an avid gamer, I have a personal interest in understanding the marketing strategies that influence my own gaming choices, which makes the research even more engaging and meaningful to me.

ii. With the rise of digital platforms and personalized content, selective marketing has become a dominant force in how products and services are promoted. Studying its impact on Gen Z gamers helps highlight how effective these strategies can be in shaping consumer behavior.

iii. The gaming industry is one of the fastest-growing sectors globally, and understanding the preferences and behaviors of Gen Z can help gaming companies stay competitive by tailoring their products and marketing campaigns to meet the expectations of this key demographic.

iv. The way Gen Z engages with media and entertainment is vastly different from previous generations. They are more likely to be influenced by digital ads, social media influencers, and peer recommendations, making it crucial to examine how selective marketing affects their gaming decisions.

v. Surat is an emerging market with a growing interest in gaming, and studying how Gen Z consumers in this city respond to marketing strategies can provide valuable insights for gaming companies looking to expand their reach and cater to local preferences.

vi. With rapid technological innovations in gaming platforms (like VR, mobile gaming, and next-gen consoles), Gen Z's preferences are constantly evolving, making it important to understand how targeted marketing can keep up with these changes.

vii. The increasing role of social media and influencers in shaping Gen Z's purchasing decisions makes this research timely. Understanding how these elements affect their gaming habits can lead to more effective marketing strategies in the gaming industry.

viii. Gen Z is not just a consumer of games but also an active participant in gaming communities, such as those on platforms like Twitch and YouTube. This study examines how selective marketing can leverage these communities to further engage gamers and foster brand loyalty.

1.1 About Industry:

The gaming industry is a multi-billion-dollar global sector that encompasses the development, publishing, distribution, and marketing of video games. It spans across various platforms, including PC, consoles, mobile devices, and virtual reality. The industry has seen explosive growth, particularly with the rise of mobile gaming, which has expanded its reach to a broader and more diverse audience. Gaming companies play a significant role in shaping the industry, with major players such as CD Projekt Red, FromSoftware, and Sony driving innovation and setting trends.

CD Projekt Red, known for *The Witcher* series and *Cyberpunk 2077*, has gained immense popularity due to its emphasis on narrative-driven games with deep lore, open-world exploration, and player choice. Despite the challenges faced with the release of *Cyberpunk 2077*, CD Projekt Red continues to be one of the most influential game developers, with a dedicated fan base. FromSoftware, another prominent developer, is renowned for its Dark Souls series, Sekiro: Shadows Die Twice, and Elden Ring. FromSoftware has created a unique niche in the gaming world with its challenging and rewarding gameplay, atmospheric world-building, and intricate combat mechanics. On the other hand, Sony (through its PlayStation division) is a key player in the console market, with the PlayStation consoles being among the top-selling gaming systems worldwide. Sony has consistently delivered groundbreaking titles such as *The Last of Us*, *Spider-Man*, and *God of War*, offering a mix of narrative-driven experiences and cutting-edge gameplay.

In recent years, mobile gaming has emerged as one of the fastest-growing segments of the gaming industry. Games like *PUBG Mobile*, *Clash of Clans*, *Candy Crush Saga*, and *Pokémon GO* have made gaming accessible to a wider audience, including casual gamers who may not have access to high-end consoles or PCs. Mobile games have become increasingly sophisticated, featuring high-quality graphics, engaging storylines, and multiplayer functionalities. One of the key factors driving the popularity of mobile gaming is its accessibility; mobile devices are widely available, and mobile games often come at low or no cost, with in-game purchases available to enhance the gaming experience. Mobile gaming also appeals to a diverse demographic, from younger players seeking fast, casual gaming experiences to older audiences looking for more accessible, time-efficient options. With the advancement of mobile technology and the rise of app stores, mobile gaming is expected to continue growing, influencing the overall direction of the gaming industry.

The preferences within mobile gaming vary widely, with different age groups gravitating toward specific genres. Casual games like *Candy Crush Saga* and *FarmVille* attract a broad, non-gamer

audience, while more hardcore gamers tend to favor titles such as *PUBG Mobile* and *Call of Duty: Mobile*, which offer more complex gameplay and competitive elements. Gen Z in particular, is drawn to mobile gaming due to its flexibility and integration with social media platforms, enabling them to share their achievements and interact with peers. Additionally, selective marketing has become more prominent in mobile gaming, where personalized advertisements and influencer promotions are tailored to specific user demographics, making the experience even more engaging for targeted audiences.

In summary, the gaming industry is diverse and expansive, with major developers like CD Projekt Red, FromSoftware, and Sony shaping the evolution of video games across consoles, PCs, and mobile platforms. As the gaming landscape continues to evolve, understanding the preferences of different demographics and leveraging selective marketing strategies will be essential for maintaining the growth and success of the industry. The mobile gaming market, in particular, offers exciting opportunities as it continues to attract new players and expand globally.

1.3 Industry Scenario:

1.1.1 Global Gaming Industry Overview:

The global gaming industry has witnessed a meteoric rise over the past few decades, emerging as one of the most lucrative sectors in the entertainment world. Valued at over $200 billion in 2023, the industry is projected to continue growing, driven by advancements in technology, growing internet penetration, and the increasing popularity of mobile, console, and PC gaming.

Key factors influencing this growth include:

- **Technological Advancements:** High-quality graphics, cloud gaming, virtual reality (VR), and augmented reality (AR) are revolutionizing the gaming experience.
- **Mobile Gaming:** Mobile gaming is one of the fastest-growing segments, with smartphones becoming a primary platform for gaming due to ease of access, lower costs, and a wide range of game genres.
- **Esports:** Competitive gaming, or esports, has gained massive popularity, with millions of viewers and players participating in tournaments worldwide. This has further contributed to the rise of professional gamers and esports teams, with industry leaders like Activision Blizzard and Riot Games establishing global leagues.
- **Social Connectivity:** Online multiplayer games, streaming platforms, and in-game social features are fostering a sense of community among players, thus increasing engagement.

  The global gaming audience is diverse, with gamers spanning across age groups, demographics, and geographical locations. However, Gen Z (born between 1997 and 2012) represents a significant portion of the gaming community, with many being digital natives who are particularly influenced by social media, influencer marketing, and the growing convergence of gaming and social interaction.

1.1.2 Global Gaming Industry Marketing:

Marketing within the gaming industry has evolved significantly. Traditional advertising has been supplemented by digital marketing, influencer collaborations, and user-generated content, which resonate more with younger audiences.

- **Influencer Marketing:** Gaming influencers and streamers on platforms like Twitch, YouTube, and TikTok play a key role in shaping purchasing decisions. Their authenticity and relatable content appeal directly to Gen Z and millennial gamers.
- **Social media & Community Engagement:** Platforms like Twitter, Instagram, Discord, and Reddit foster direct interaction between game developers, players, and marketing teams, allowing brands to build communities and engage with fans on a personal level.
- **Targeted Advertising:** Marketers are increasingly using data-driven strategies to tailor advertisements to specific groups within Gen Z, based on gaming preferences, geographical location, and digital behavior.
- **Collaborations with Music and Pop Culture:** Partnerships between game companies and global brands (e.g., Fortnite collaborating with Marvel, Travis Scott, or Nike) have bridged the gap between gaming and pop culture, attracting a wider audience.

1.1.3 The Indian Gaming Industry:

India has seen rapid growth in its gaming industry over the past decade. As of 2023, the Indian gaming market was valued at over $2.6 billion and is projected to reach $8.6 billion by 2027. This growth is fuelled by several factors:

- **Smartphone Penetration:** With the widespread availability of affordable smartphones, mobile gaming has become the entry point for many young gamers in India.
- **Internet Accessibility:** The expansion of affordable high-speed internet, especially with the launch of 5G technology, has further boosted mobile and online gaming.
- **Growing E-sports Scene:** Esports in India is on the rise, with tournaments, sponsorships, and growing interest from gaming companies. Popular games like PUBG Mobile, Free Fire, and Call of Duty have a large following in India.
- **Cultural Influence:** Western games like Fortnite and PUBG have massive appeal, but India also has a growing appetite for homegrown games, including games like Ludo King and Carrom Pool, which are culturally familiar to Indian audiences.

.1.4 Gaming Marketing in India:

Marketing strategies for gaming companies in India are adapting to the preferences and behaviours of young, tech-savvy consumers. Gen Z in India is particularly unique because of their high social media usage, affinity for influencers, and interest in online streaming and content creation.

- **Influencer and Content Creator Collaborations:** Indian gaming influencers like Dynamo Gaming, Mortal, and CarryMinati (who also creates content around gaming) have huge followings on YouTube and Twitch. Their influence extends beyond just game promotion, with many also creating their own brands and merchandise, thus making them key players in marketing campaigns.
- **Localized Content and Customization:** Game developers are creating region-specific content to cater to the tastes and cultural nuances of Indian gamers. This includes language options, Indian themes, and local in-game events.
- **Celebrity Endorsements and Sponsorships:** Just as in the global market, Indian gaming companies are increasingly turning to Bollywood celebrities and sports personalities for marketing and sponsorships. For instance, Virat Kohli and Ranveer Singh have endorsed mobile gaming titles.
- **Digital Marketing:** Marketers leverage Facebook, Instagram, TikTok, Twitter, and YouTube to run targeted ads. Given the high engagement of Indian Gen Z on these platforms, gaming ads are frequently integrated into the content they already consume.

1.1.5 Selective Marketing for Gen Z:

Selective marketing in the gaming industry refers to the tailored marketing approach where specific gaming products, content, and advertisements are targeted at certain segments of the population. For Gen Z, this approach is particularly effective, as they are often attracted to personalized content that resonates with their interests, lifestyles, and digital behavior.

Gaming companies are increasingly utilizing data analytics to study user behavior and customize marketing efforts. The rise of micro-targeting allows brands to:

- **Target Specific Gaming Preferences:** Whether it's action games, battle royales, or sports simulations, marketers can tailor their messaging based on the genres that specific subsets of Gen Z enjoy.
- **Create Hyper-Personalized Campaigns:** Through social media platforms and gaming apps, marketers can create hyper-personalized content that appeals to Gen Z's desire for uniqueness and self-expression.
- **Influencer and Community-Driven Campaigns:** Gen Z is more likely to respond to campaigns that feel authentic and are driven by influencers they trust. Selective marketing ensures that these campaigns are aligned with the interests and values of the targeted audience.

1.1.6 Impact of Selective Marketing on Gen Z in the Gaming Industry

The selective marketing strategies targeting Gen Z have had a profound impact on their gaming preferences, spending behaviours, and engagement with game brands. This generation is more likely to engage with gaming content that feels personalized and authentic, and they are particularly influenced by:

- **Peer Recommendations:** Word-of-mouth and influencer opinions play a significant role in shaping Gen Z's purchase decisions.
- **Social media and FOMO (Fear of Missing Out**): Social media platforms amplify trends and popular games, creating a sense of urgency and exclusivity around certain game releases or in-game events.
- **Gamified Advertising:** Gen Z has a higher tolerance for advertisements that integrate with gaming experiences, such as interactive ads or in-game rewards for watching ads.

  Selective marketing has allowed gaming companies to engage with Gen Z in more meaningful ways, increasing brand loyalty, player retention, and in-game purchases.

1.2 Contemporary Issues:

1. Data Privacy and Security:

As gaming moves increasingly online, concerns over data privacy and the security of personal information are growing. Many gaming platforms collect vast amounts of user data, which can be vulnerable to breaches, leading to potential misuse or hacking of accounts.

2. Addiction and Mental Health:

There is rising concern about gaming addiction, especially among younger audiences like Gen Z. The immersive nature of modern games can lead to excessive screen time, negatively affecting mental health, social relationships, and academic performance.

3. In-Game Monetization:

Monetization models like loot boxes, microtransactions, and pay-to-win mechanics have sparked debate. While they provide revenue for developers, critics argue they exploit players, especially younger ones, and can lead to a sense of unfairness in gameplay.

4. Diversity and Representation:

The gaming industry has faced criticism for its lack of diversity in game characters, stories, and development teams. Many games have been dominated by male protagonists and stereotypical representations of gender, race, and sexuality, though there is growing demand for more inclusive and varied narratives.

5. Toxicity and Harassment in Gaming Communities:

The rise of online multiplayer games has brought about issues of toxic behavior, including harassment, bullying, and hate speech within gaming communities. Many players, particularly women and minorities, face online abuse, creating a hostile environment for gaming.

6. Regulatory Challenges:

With gaming's increasing popularity, especially in emerging markets, governments are considering stricter regulations on gaming, particularly in areas like loot boxes, gambling, and age restrictions. Some countries have even banned certain games or gaming platforms due to concerns about violence, addiction, or national security.

7. Environmental Impact:

The environmental cost of gaming hardware, such as high-power consumption for gaming consoles and PCs, is an emerging issue. Additionally, the production of physical copies and the environmental footprint of data centres supporting online gaming services contribute to the industry's carbon footprint.

8. Gender Inequality in Esports:

While esports have seen tremendous growth, gender inequality persists, with women often facing barriers to entry in competitive gaming, representation in esports teams, and career opportunities in the field.

These contemporary issues challenge the gaming industry as it continues to evolve and cater to a global, diverse, and tech-savvy audience.

1.3 Other Related Information:

Here's a representation of some additional information related to the global and Indian gaming industry in chart form, along with relevant ratios where applicable:

1. Global Gaming Industry Market Value Growth (2020-2027):

Table No. 1

Year	Market Value (in Billion USD)	Annual Growth Rate (%)
2020	159.3	-
2021	176.0	10.5%
2022	190.0	8.0%
2023	200.0	5.3%
2024	215.0	7.5%
2025	230.0	7.0%
2027	240.0	4.3%

- This table reflects the projected growth of the global gaming industry.

2. **Revenue Breakdown by Game Type (2023):**

Table No. 2

Game Type	Revenue (in Billion USD)	Percentage of Total Revenue (%)
Mobile Gaming	92.0	46%
Console Gaming	48.0	24%
PC Gaming	32.0	16%
Esports and Streaming	20.0	10%
Other (AR/VR, etc.)	8.0	4%

- This chart provides an estimate of the share of total revenue in the gaming industry by different gaming platforms and categories.

3. **Indian Gaming Industry Growth (2020-2027):**

Table No. 3

Year	Market Value (in Billion INR)	Annual Growth Rate (%)
2020	19,000	-
2021	23,000	21.1%
2022	25,000	8.7%
2023	26,500	6.0%
2024	30,000	13.5%

2025	35,000	16.7%
2027	65,000	22.9%

- The market value is projected to grow significantly as the mobile gaming market expands in India.

4. Gen Z Gaming Demographics (2023):

Table No. 4

Region	Percentage of Gamers Who Are Gen Z (%)
North America	30%
Europe	25%
Asia-Pacific	35%
Latin America	40%

- These statistics show the percentage of Gen Z gamers relative to the overall gaming population in key regions.

5. Average Revenue Per User (ARPU) in Mobile Gaming (2023):

Table No. 5

Region	ARPU (in USD)
North America	15
Europe	12
Asia-Pacific	8
Latin America	4

- ARPU represents the average revenue generated per player in mobile gaming in each region.

6. Mobile Gaming Market Share by Genre (2023):

Table No. 6

Genre	Revenue Share (%)
Action/Adventure	30%
Strategy	20%
Puzzle	18%
Sports	12%
Simulation	10%
Other	10%

- This chart shows the distribution of revenue across various genres within the mobile gaming market.

7. Esports Market Overview (2023):

Table No. 7

Category	Value (in Billion USD)	Growth Rate (%)
Total Esports Revenue	1.38	14%
Sponsorship & Advertising	0.75	18%
Media Rights	0.30	12%
Merchandise & Ticketing	0.18	10%
Game Publisher Fees	0.15	10%

- The chart shows the breakdown of total esports revenue in 2023 by major revenue categories.

8. Global Gaming Platforms (2023):

Table No. 8

Platform	Market Share (%)
Mobile (Smartphone/Tablet)	50%
PC (Windows/macOS)	30%
Console (PS, Xbox, etc.)	20%

- Mobile gaming continues to dominate as the largest platform in terms of market share, especially in developing markets like India.

9. Average Time Spent on Gaming Per Week by Age Group:

Table No. 9

Age Group	Average Time Spent (Hours per Week)
Gen Z (18-24)	15.3
Millennials (25-40)	12.5
Gen X (41-56)	8.0
Boomers (57+)	4.5

- Gen Z spends significantly more time gaming than older generations, reflecting their higher engagement with gaming.

10. Gaming Spending Breakdown in India (2023):

Table No. 10

Spending Category	Percentage of Total Gaming Spend (%)
Mobile Games (Microtransactions)	50%
In-App Purchases (Free-to-Play Games)	25%
Console & PC Games (One-time Purchase)	15%
Esports & Tournaments	10%

- The majority of gaming revenue in India is generated from mobile games, especially through microtransactions and in-app purchases.

Chapter 2:

Company Profile

2.1 Inception/Founder:

To give you an example of an Inception/Founder section for a gaming company, I will use **CD Projekt Red** as a case study, the developer behind **Cyberpunk 2077**:

Inception/Founder: CD Projekt Red

CD Projekt Red was founded with the aim to provide gamers with high-quality, immersive RPG experiences. The company's vision was to create games that would set new standards in the gaming industry, blending storytelling, open-world design, and innovation.

CD Projekt Red was founded in 1994 by Marcin Iwiński and Michał Kiciński, two Polish entrepreneurs who were passionate about video games and wanted to create a game development company that stood out for its commitment to quality and creativity. Initially, the company was a distributor of video games in Poland, but they soon decided to enter game development, leading to the birth of CD Projekt Red.

The company is known for focusing on a global audience of gamers who are passionate about storytelling, immersive gameplay, and deep narratives. Their games, especially the Witcher series, have garnered a loyal fanbase worldwide.

CD Projekt Red started its journey by first distributing games in Poland, but the founders quickly recognized a gap in the market for high-quality role-playing games (RPGs) and shifted their focus to development. In 2007, they released The Witcher, which was a commercial and critical success, allowing them to become one of the top gaming developers in the world. Their commitment to anti-microtransaction policies and offering free downloadable content (DLC) made them popular among players.

CD Projekt Red was officially founded in 1994. They gained significant recognition in the gaming industry in 2007 with the release of The Witcher, and their international breakthrough occurred with the release of The Witcher 3: Wild Hunt in 2015. Their most recent release, Cyberpunk 2077, launched in December 2020, despite a troubled launch.

CD Projekt Red is based in Warsaw, Poland, but it has several offices across the world, including in the United States, France, and other countries. This global presence has allowed them to connect with a broad spectrum of gamers and expand their influence internationally.

CD Projekt Red's vision is to create games that redefine storytelling, making them more engaging, immersive, and meaningful. They strive to create worlds that players can get lost in, with complex narratives and deep character development.

The mission of CD Projekt Red is to be one of the most respected game development studios in the world, focusing on creating top-tier games while adhering to values such as innovation, player freedom, and customer satisfaction. The company also aims to remain committed to providing players with a high-quality experience, free of exploitative practices like excessive microtransactions.

CD Projekt Red aims to consistently deliver groundbreaking RPG titles with compelling stories and expansive worlds. The company's objective is to maintain its reputation for quality, which includes delivering free content updates, avoiding pay-to-win mechanics, and continuing to innovate in terms of game mechanics and player experience.

2.2 Company's Products Mix:

CD Projekt Red's product mix includes:

1. **Main Game Titles**: The company is known for its role-playing games (RPGs), with flagship titles like The Witcher series and Cyberpunk 2077. These games offer immersive worlds, complex narratives, and innovative gameplay, drawing a global fanbase.
2. **Game Expansions & DLCs**: CD Projekt Red regularly releases major expansions for its games. For example, Hearts of Stone and Blood and Wine for The Witcher 3: Wild Hunt, and Phantom Liberty for Cyberpunk 2077. These expansions add new content, storylines, and gameplay features, enhancing the base game experience.
3. **Digital Products**: The company offers digital editions of its games, including special and deluxe versions that contain extra in-game content, art books, soundtracks, and more. They also provide modding tools for fans to create custom content, particularly for The Witcher 3.

4. **Merchandise & Collectibles**: CD Projekt Red capitalizes on its game's popularity by offering a range of merchandise, including action figures, apparel, posters, and other collectibles, especially for The Witcher and Cyberpunk. They also release special collector's editions of their games with exclusive physical items like maps, figurines, and detailed art books.

5. **Media & Licensing**: The company has expanded into other media forms, including book adaptations and a Netflix TV series based on The Witcher. This has contributed to the broader cultural impact of the games. Additionally, Cyberpunk 2077 has been adapted into comic books and other narrative-driven media.

6. **Game Engines & Development Tools**: CD Projekt Red developed its proprietary engine, REDengine, which powers their open-world RPGs. The engine has been integral to the success of their titles, enabling detailed graphics, large environments, and interactive storytelling. They also offer REDkit, a toolset for modders to create custom content for games.

7. **In-Game Purchases (Microtransactions)**: Although CD Projekt Red has traditionally avoided microtransactions in their core single-player games, they have included them in other projects like Gwent and Cyberpunk 2077, where players can purchase cosmetic items or expansions.

Overall, CD Projekt Red's product mix goes beyond just games. It includes digital editions, expansions, physical merchandise, and adaptations into books, TV series, and comics, ensuring the company has a strong presence across multiple platforms and media. Their games' success, combined with a variety of related products, has solidified their place as a global leader in the gaming industry.

2.3 Branches/Offices/Locations/Production Sites:

CD Projekt Red, headquartered in Warsaw, Poland, operates globally with multiple offices and branches. Here's an overview of their locations:

Figure No. 2

Headquarters:

- Warsaw, Poland

Production Sites and Development Offices:

- CD Projekt Red Krakow
- CD Project Red Wroclaw
- CD Project Red Gdansk

International Offices

- Los Angeles, USA
- Shanghai, China
- London, UK
- Montreal, Canada

1. **Headquarters - Warsaw, Poland:**

- Location: Warsaw, Poland
- Function: The primary headquarters for CD Projekt Red, the heart of the company's operations. It houses top management, the game design, development, and marketing teams, and acts as the central hub for global strategy, publishing, and decision-making. The REDengine development and game design studios are based here, contributing to major projects like The Witcher series and Cyberpunk 2077.

2. Development Offices/Production Sites in Poland

<u>CD Projekt Red Kraków</u>

- Location: Kraków, Poland
- Function: This office is one of the company's main development sites. It plays a key role in the production of Cyberpunk 2077 and the expansions for The Witcher 3. Kraków's team works on world-building, character modelling, animation, and creating additional game content. It's one of the largest of CD Projekt Red's studios, with over 200 employees contributing to the development process.

CD Projekt Red Wrocław

- Location: Wrocław, Poland
- Function: Another essential studio for CD Projekt Red, specializing in quality assurance (QA), testing, and troubleshooting during game development. This location helps ensure the games meet the company's high standards of gameplay and performance. The Wrocław office also supports development tasks for both core titles and expansions.

CD Projekt Red Gdańsk

- Location: Gdańsk, Poland
- Function: Gdańsk office focuses primarily on game design and development, with a specific focus on story writing, world-building, and creative development. The studio contributes to both The Witcher franchise and Cyberpunk 2077 expansions, with writers and designers creating content for both the narrative and open-world experiences.

3. International Offices:

CD Projekt Red Los Angeles, USA

- Location: Los Angeles, California, USA
- Function: The LA office plays a vital role in the North American market, which is crucial for CD Projekt Red's global reach. It manages marketing campaigns, public relations, community engagement, and event coordination for games like Cyberpunk 2077 and The Witcher series. The office also handles relations with major media outlets, influencers, and gaming communities across the United States and Canada.

CD Projekt Red Shanghai, China

- Location: Shanghai, China
- Function: This office helps CD Projekt Red expand into the rapidly growing Asian market. It focuses on game distribution, localization, and marketing efforts tailored to Chinese gamers, ensuring that their games resonate with the local culture and preferences. The office works closely with local partners to ensure the games' success in the Asian gaming ecosystem.

CD Projekt Red London, UK

- Location: London, United Kingdom

- Function: CD Projekt Red's London office is responsible for managing marketing strategies, community outreach, and maintaining relationships with gaming media and influencers in the UK and broader European market. London's team works closely with local retailers, publishers, and distributors to promote game releases and expansion packs.

CD Projekt Red Montreal, Canada

- Location: Montreal, Quebec, Canada
- Function: Although this office was initially established to assist in the production of Cyberpunk 2077, the Montreal studio now helps support ongoing development and expansion efforts for multiple CD Projekt Red games. The Montreal branch focuses on providing expertise in technical development, quality assurance, and assisting with the integration of new technologies into the games.

4. Other Global Production Locations:

CD Projekt Red's presence in key cities across Europe: CD Projekt Red also maintains a presence in other parts of Europe, such as Berlin, Paris, and Stockholm, primarily for sales, marketing, and local game distribution. These locations are integral in ensuring that CD Projekt Red games are accessible to the European gaming community and support localized content to cater to different languages and cultures.

5. Production Facilities and Game Development

Production Facilities in Poland: CD Projekt Red's main production facilities are in Poland, with large-scale development operations that include creating detailed in-game environments, animations, and voice acting. The offices in Kraków, Wrocław, and Gdańsk all contribute in various ways to the development of games like The Witcher 3 and Cyberpunk 2077, from conceptual design to final execution.

Summary:

CD Projekt Red operates a globally distributed network of offices and production sites, with a strong presence in its home country of Poland and international branches in major markets like the USA, China, the UK, and Canada. Each office and studio have its distinct role, from game development and design to marketing, sales, and localization. These global offices and production sites contribute significantly to the company's ability to create and deliver high-quality, immersive games while expanding its reach in global markets.

2.4 Marketing Practises:

Marketing Practices of CD Projekt Red – The Cyberpunk 2077 Journey:

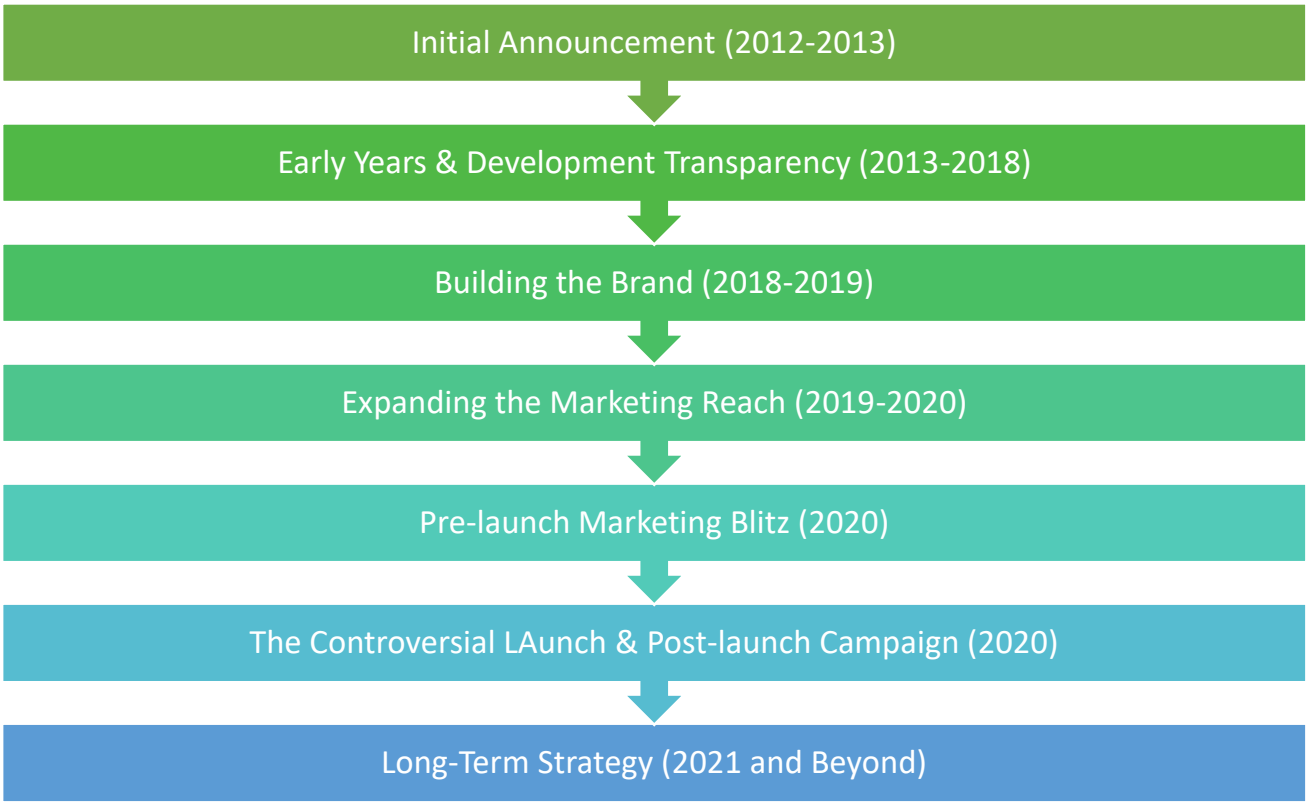
Figure No. 3

CD Projekt Red's marketing campaign for *Cyberpunk 2077* was a masterclass in generating hype and anticipation. The developer employed a variety of selective marketing strategies, such as cinematic trailers, celebrity endorsements (including Keanu Reeves), and influencer partnerships, all of which targeted their core demographic—gamers who enjoy open-world RPGs and futuristic settings. The company also used social media and community-driven content to build excitement around the game, positioning it as one of the most anticipated releases in the gaming world. This highly targeted approach succeeded in creating a massive buzz and establishing *Cyberpunk 2077* as a highly anticipated title.

However, the game's actual release was plagued with technical issues, bugs, and performance problems, particularly on older consoles, which were not highlighted in the marketing materials. This disparity between the marketing promises and the final product led to backlash from fans and a tarnished reputation for CD Projekt Red. Despite offering refunds and working on patches to fix the issues, the damage was done. The *Cyberpunk 2077* experience underscores the risks of selective marketing—while it can build excitement, it must align with the product's quality to avoid damaging consumer trust and brand loyalty. This case highlights the importance of maintaining authenticity in

marketing and ensuring that the final product meets the high expectations set by promotional campaigns.

Figure No. 4



1. Initial Announcement (2012-2013)

- First Tease: The first hint of Cyberpunk 2077 came in 2012, with a teaser trailer showing a dystopian, cyberpunk-inspired city. The trailer didn't reveal much but created intrigue.
- Early Hype: CD Projekt Red built anticipation by positioning the game as their next big title following the success of The Witcher 3. The brief teaser and logo stirred the imaginations of gaming fans worldwide, planting the seed for future excitement.

2. Early Years & Development Transparency (2013-2018)

- Unveiling the Vision: In 2013, CD Projekt Red revealed more details about Cyberpunk 2077, offering fans insight into the game's setting, characters, and development plans. The game was positioned as a futuristic RPG in an open-world, high-tech, and gritty environment.
- Developer Updates: CD Projekt Red was transparent about the development process, sharing their vision for Cyberpunk 2077 with the world through interviews and behind-the-scenes

glimpses. They often highlighted the game's open-world gameplay and complex narrative choices, which captured the attention of gamers who were familiar with the studio's previous successes.

3. Building the Brand (2018-2019)

- First Gameplay Reveal (2018): At E3 2018, CD Projekt Red unveiled a gameplay demo of Cyberpunk 2077. The gameplay showed off the vibrant world of Night City and set a new standard for open-world exploration. The presentation sparked a huge buzz, and the gameplay video became one of the most-watched in E3 history.
- Keanu Reeves Reveal (2019): One of the most impactful moments in the game's marketing history was the unexpected reveal of Keanu Reeves as a central character, Johnny Silverhand, during E3 2019. This generated huge mainstream media attention and further solidified the game's pop culture relevance. His surprise appearance in the trailer went viral and became one of the defining moments of the game's marketing.

4. Expanding the Marketing Reach (2019-2020)

- Partnerships and Collaborations: CD Projekt Red continued to build momentum by teaming up with various brands and influencers. The game received significant support from YouTubers and Twitch streamers, who were given early access to exclusive content, promoting the game to their vast audiences. The involvement of major streamers like Valkyrae and Pokimane expanded the game's reach into the Gen Z audience.
- Cyberpunk 2077 Website & Social Media: CD Projekt Red capitalized on the power of social media to create an immersive marketing campaign. The game's official website, along with social media platforms (Twitter, Instagram, YouTube), was filled with world-building content, interactive posts, and regular updates. The developers actively engaged with fans and responded to questions, making the game feel more personal and accessible.

5. Pre-launch Marketing Blitz (2020)

- Launch Event: The anticipation for Cyberpunk 2077 grew exponentially in the lead-up to its December 2020 release. CD Projekt Red held live events, including a Night City Wire series on YouTube, where they unveiled new information about the game, characters, and the game's expansive world. This kept the hype at a fever pitch.

- Influencer Marketing: The company also partnered with influencers and content creators, gifting early access to the game and exclusive in-game items to engage the community. This created a buzz before the game's official release and increased word-of-mouth advertising.

6. The Controversial Launch & Post-launch Campaign (2020)

- Launch Hype & Criticism: Cyberpunk 2077 became one of the most highly anticipated games in history, but its launch was marred by performance issues, especially on older consoles. Despite this, CD Projekt Red continued to heavily market the game post-launch with extensive promotional campaigns, offering apologies and free DLCs for players to restore faith in the product.
- Refunds and Controversy: Amid the backlash, CD Projekt Red offered refunds to unhappy customers and promised updates to fix the performance issues. Their apology and commitment to improvement was part of their transparent marketing approach. They released several patches, and communication through their social media platforms was aimed at regaining trust from players.

7. Long-Term Strategy (2021 and Beyond)

- Post-launch Updates & DLC: The company doubled down on the long-term marketing strategy by continuously releasing patches, DLCs, and expansions for Cyberpunk 2077. This included Phantom Liberty, a major expansion that was heavily marketed through teaser trailers, media interviews, and influencer engagement.
- Community Engagement: CD Projekt Red continued to foster a strong community around Cyberpunk 2077 by releasing updates about game developments, fan contests, and collaborating with fan artists. This kept the community engaged and created buzz around the game, even amid criticism.

Conclusion

The marketing strategy for Cyberpunk 2077 was multi-faceted, ambitious, and highly interactive, with a heavy reliance on social media, influencers, events, and partnerships. While the game's launch was controversial due to technical issues, the marketing campaign succeeded in creating immense anticipation and engaging gamers globally. The mix of influencer partnerships, celebrity involvement (like Keanu Reeves), live-stream events, and transparency helped build an exceptional level of excitement around the game. CD Projekt Red’s long-term commitment to improving the game post-

launch, through regular updates and DLC, demonstrates how their marketing evolved to maintain player trust and keep the game's cultural relevance alive.

2.5 Last three years brief financial data:

Below is a simplified table representing the last three years' financial data of CD Projekt Red, focusing on revenue and net profit for the company, especially in light of the launch of Cyberpunk 2077.

Table No. 11

Year	Revenue (PLN)	Revenue (INR)	Net Profit (PLN)	Net Profit (INR)	Key Notes
2021	1.0 billion	5940 million	180 million	3840 million	Cyberpunk 2077 affected sales due to technical issues. - Focus on fixing the game and providing updates and patches.
2022	1.1 billion	6490 million	400 million	8560 million	Recovery from Cyberpunk 2077 issues. - Released major patch updates and new content. - Expanded Cyberpunk 2077 with new DLC (Phantom Liberty).
2023	1.3 billion	7700 million	500 million	10,800 million	Continued expansion of Cyberpunk 2077. - The Witcher series continued to perform well. - Investments in new game development.

2024	1.4 billion	8250 million	550 million	11,840 million	Continued success of Cyberpunk 2077 post-expansion. - Expected increase due to Witcher 4 development. - Launch of new game titles.

2.6 HR Practices in the Company:

HR Practices at CD Projekt Red:

1. **Recruitment and Talent Acquisition**: Actively recruits top talent in fields like game design, programming, and art from diverse backgrounds.
2. **Diversity and Inclusion**: Ensures a balanced workforce, promoting gender and cultural diversity and maintaining an inclusive work environment.
3. **Work-Life Balance**: Flexible working hours, remote work options, and wellness programs to promote a balanced lifestyle, especially after criticism of crunch time.
4. **Training and Development**: Offers ongoing opportunities for skill development, workshops, and on-the-job learning to help employees grow.
5. **Compensation and Benefits**: Provides competitive salaries, performance bonuses, health insurance, and other benefits like free game access.
6. **Employee Feedback**: Regular surveys and feedback mechanisms to gauge employee satisfaction and address concerns.
7. **Leadership Development**: Internal leadership development programs, focusing on promoting from within and fostering leadership qualities among employees.
8. **Employee Recognition**: Implements recognition systems, including awards, celebrations, and public acknowledgment of achievements.
9. **Career Advancement**: Offers ample opportunities for growth through internal promotions, giving employees a clear path for career progression.

10. **Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR)**: Encourages employees to participate in volunteer programs and charitable causes, supporting broader societal well-being.
11. **Transparency and Communication**: Maintains an open-door policy, encouraging honest communication between staff and leadership.
12. **Retention Strategies**: Focuses on creating a motivating and supportive work culture, which aids in retaining skilled employees.
13. **Inclusive Work Culture**: Strives to create a welcoming, inclusive environment where employees from all walks of life feel valued.
14. **Workplace Flexibility**: Provides options for flexible hours and remote work, enabling employees to balance their personal and professional lives.
15. **Employee Well-being Programs**: In addition to physical wellness, the company offers mental health resources and stress management initiatives.
16. **Team Collaboration**: Fosters a collaborative and creative team environment, encouraging open communication and idea sharing.
17. **Global Talent Pool**: Leverages global recruitment channels to attract international talent, bringing diverse perspectives into the team.
18. **Employee Involvement**: Actively involves employees in decision-making processes and company initiatives, ensuring their voices are heard.
19. **Promoting Innovation**: Encourages employees to bring fresh ideas, supporting an innovative and forward-thinking work culture.
20. **Competitive Perks**: Beyond financial compensation, offers perks like game discounts, employee events, and team-building activities to enhance job satisfaction.

2.7 Achievement and Recent news about Company:

Achievements and Recent News about CD Projekt Red:

1. **Success of Cyberpunk 2077**:

   Despite its rocky launch, CD Projekt Red successfully turned Cyberpunk 2077 into a highly regarded game with significant post-launch updates and improvements. The game earned accolades and recognition for its world-building, story, and technology after several major patches fixed bugs and performance issues.

2. **Awards and Nominations**:

   CD Projekt Red's work on *The Witcher 3: Wild Hunt* continues to be highly praised. The game won multiple Game of the Year awards in 2015 and remains one of the best-selling games of all time, continuing to receive accolades for its narrative and design.

3. **Expansion into New Projects**:

   CD Projekt Red announced plans to expand its portfolio beyond the *Witcher* and *Cyberpunk* franchises, exploring new game universes. This includes the development of *The Witcher 4*, as well as a new *Cyberpunk* sequel and a *new IP* (intellectual property).

4. **Improved Customer Relations**:

   The company made significant efforts to rebuild its reputation after the controversial launch of *Cyberpunk 2077*. They issued public apologies, offered refunds, and worked diligently to improve the game's performance, leading to renewed support from the gaming community.

5. **Partnerships and Collaborations**:

   CD Projekt Red has collaborated with Netflix for *The Witcher* series, which became a massive success and increased the global visibility of the *Witcher* franchise. Additionally, the company expanded into the world of digital collectibles and NFTs, launching new ways to interact with their franchises.

6. **Transition to Next-Gen Consoles**:

   In 2021, CD Projekt Red released next-gen updates for both *The Witcher 3* and *Cyberpunk 2077*, improving graphics and performance for the PlayStation 5 and Xbox Series X/S consoles. This was a key step in ensuring the longevity of their titles across different gaming platforms.

7. **Commitment to Sustainability**:

   The company made significant strides in focusing on sustainability by reducing carbon emissions and implementing eco-friendly practices in its operations. It has taken steps towards reducing environmental impacts as part of a broader corporate social responsibility agenda.

8. **Positive Financial Performance**: Despite early controversies surrounding *Cyberpunk 2077*, CD Projekt Red achieved impressive financial results. In 2021, the company reported record-breaking revenues and profits, bolstered by ongoing sales of *Cyberpunk 2077* and *The Witcher 3*, alongside growing support for digital content.

9. **Commitment to Future Innovations**:

   CD Projekt Red has committed to enhancing its development pipeline with the use of advanced technology, including AI and improved game engines to create more immersive experiences. The company is investing in the development of new game engines for the next generation of titles.

10. **Employee and Workplace Recognition**:

    CD Projekt Red received praise for its efforts in improving its workplace culture and employee satisfaction, especially after the criticisms of its "crunch" periods during *Cyberpunk 2077* development. The company made strides to improve work conditions and provide better support for its staff.

Below are the figures that showcases the future aesthetics of Cyberpunk 2077:

Figure No. 5

Figure No.6

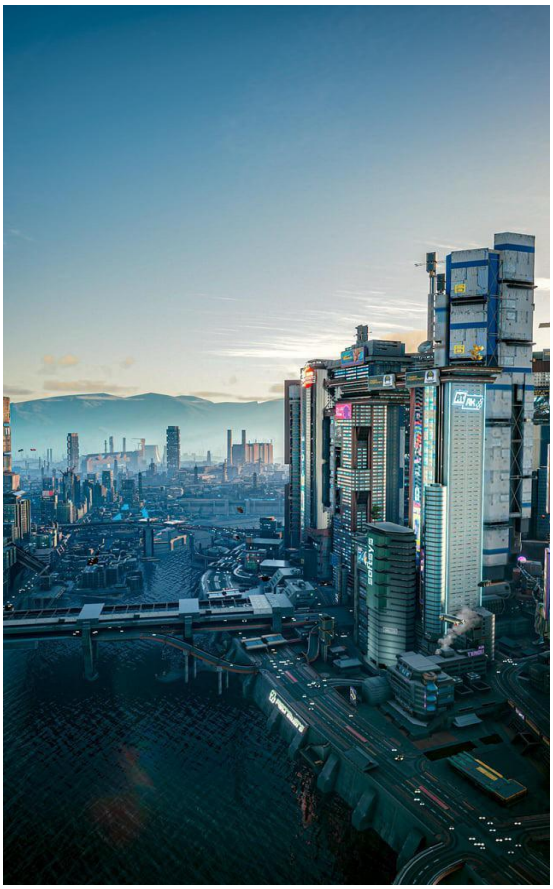


Figure No.7

Chapter 3:

Theoretical Framework & Literature Review

Part I:

3.1 Theoretical Framework:

3.1.1 Introduction to Selective Marketing:

Selective marketing, also referred to as targeted marketing or niche marketing, focuses on directing marketing efforts towards a specific audience or demographic segment. It involves crafting personalized marketing messages and campaigns to cater to the particular needs, preferences, and behaviors of that segment. Selective marketing aims to increase engagement and conversion rates by making the marketing efforts more relevant and personalized to the audience.

Definition:

Selective marketing refers to the process by which marketers target a specific subset of the general market. This segmentation allows them to focus on the most profitable or interested consumers, rather than spreading resources thin by trying to reach a broad audience. The goal is to maximize the effectiveness of marketing campaigns by addressing the distinct needs and desires of each consumer group.

3.1.2 Theories of Selective Marketing

Theories around selective marketing revolve around understanding consumer behavior, segmenting markets, and using these segments to create personalized communication strategies.

<u>Consumer Behavior Theory:</u>

- Psychological factors: Factors such as motivation, perception, learning, and beliefs influence consumer behavior. Marketers use this knowledge to create messages that resonate with their target segment's specific psychological needs.
- Social factors: Peer influence, social status, family dynamics, and social class also affect decision-making and can be leveraged in marketing strategies.

<u>Market Segmentation Theory:</u>

Market segmentation is a key theory behind selective marketing. This approach is based on the idea that consumers within a market differ from one another, and thus, mass marketing strategies are less

effective. Through segmentation, businesses can create targeted strategies that appeal to different consumer types. The major types of segmentation include:

- Demographic Segmentation: Based on variables such as age, gender, income, and education.
- Geographic Segmentation: Based on location, such as region, climate, or population density.
- Psychographic Segmentation: Based on lifestyle, values, interests, and opinions.
- Behavioural Segmentation: Based on consumer behavior, including purchase patterns, brand loyalty, and usage frequency.

3.1.3 Factors Affecting Selective Marketing

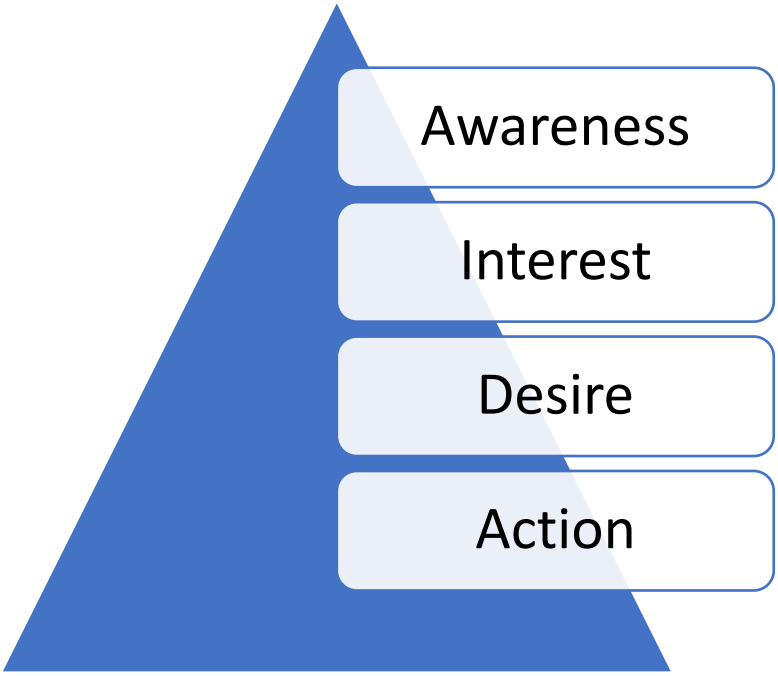
1) **Demographics**: Age, gender, income, and education level can significantly influence the types of games individuals prefer to play and how they interact with gaming content.
2) **Psychographics**: Consumers' interests, values, and lifestyle choices impact their gaming preferences, such as the genres or platforms they prefer.
3) **Marketing Communication**: Advertising, promotions, and social media campaigns shape gamers' perceptions and influence their decision to try or buy new games.
4) **Peer Influence**: Recommendations and gaming habits of friends, family, and online communities can drive a person's choice of games or gaming habits.
5) **Technological Advancements**: The availability of new gaming technologies, like VR headsets or high-performance consoles, affects the types of games consumers are likely to engage with.

3.1.4 Models of Selective Marketing

Several models help explain how selective marketing operates. These models are useful in understanding how brands can effectively segment, target, and position their products.

AIDA Model:

Figure No. 8



The AIDA Model (Attention, Interest, Desire, Action) is a marketing communication model that explains how customers move through a journey from awareness to decision-making. Here's how the AIDA model applies to the findings of your survey:

1. Attention

At this stage, marketers need to capture the attention of their target audience. Based on my survey, 55% of respondents play games daily or several times a week. To grab their attention, companies could use gaming ads on platforms where these active gamers are present (e.g., YouTube or social media). For instance, flashy, eye-catching ads about a new game would appeal to the active gamer audience.

2. Interest

Once having their attention, you need to foster interest in game. My survey showed that most gamers prefer playing RPGs (24%). Marketers could tailor ads to emphasize specific genres, like showcasing immersive storylines or gameplay mechanics that appeal to RPG fans.

3. Desire

Here, marketers create a strong desire for the product by showing how it fulfils the needs or desires of the consumers. If respondents prefer playing games alone or with friends (50%), marketers could highlight the social features of a game or its solo-play capabilities, promoting how the game can enhance their gaming experience with their specific preferences in mind.

4. Action

Finally, marketers encourage consumers to take action, like purchasing the game. Based on the survey data, students and employed people are more likely to play regularly, so special offers or discounts targeted to these segments (e.g., student discounts or job-related rewards) could drive these groups to take the next step, such as buying or pre-ordering the game.

This structured approach using the AIDA model ensures that marketing campaigns are more aligned with consumer behavior and preferences, as seen in your survey results.

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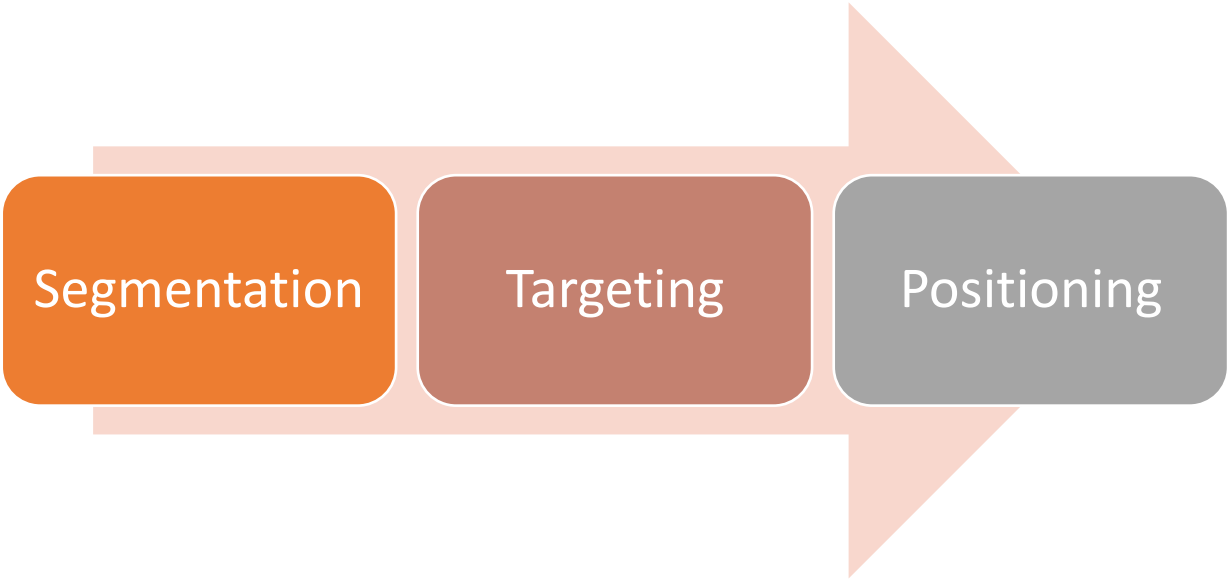
STP Model:

The STP (Segmentation, Targeting, Positioning) model is foundational to selective marketing. It outlines the process of:

Figure No. 9



1. Segmentation

Segmentation involves dividing a broad market into smaller, distinct groups based on certain characteristics like demographics, behaviors, or interests. This step helps businesses understand the diverse needs of their audience. Common segmentation criteria include:

- Demographics: Age, gender, income
- Psychographics: Interests, lifestyles, values
- Geographics: Location, region
- Behavioural: Purchasing habits, brand loyalty

2. Targeting

Targeting is the process of selecting which segments to focus on. Once you've segmented the market, you evaluate which segments are the most viable and align best with your product's strengths. You may choose to target:

- Mass Market: Targeting the whole market.
- Niche Market: Focusing on a smaller, more specific segment.
- Differentiated Marketing: Targeting multiple segments with different strategies.
- Undifferentiated Marketing: Offering one product to the entire market.

3. Positioning

Positioning involves crafting a marketing message to appeal directly to the chosen target segment. The goal is to differentiate your product in the market by emphasizing its unique value, benefits, and appeal. It's about how you want consumers to perceive your product in comparison to competitors.

By following the STP process, businesses can tailor their marketing efforts to be more effective and relevant to specific consumer groups.

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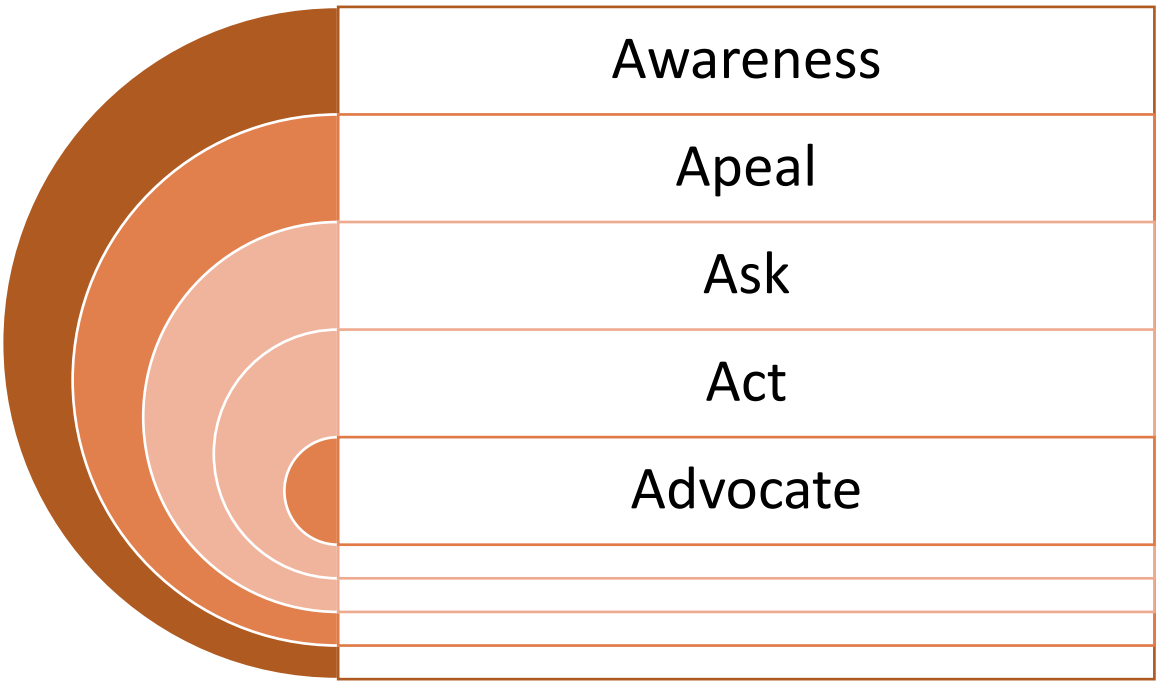
5A's Model (Kotler's Model of Marketing):

Kotler's 5A model—Aware, Appeal, Ask, Act, Advocate—helps marketers understand the consumer journey:

Figure No. 10



The 5 A's is a customer journey model used in marketing that focuses on the steps a customer takes when interacting with a brand or product. The model helps marketers understand how to guide customers through each stage from awareness to advocacy. Here's how the 5 A's can relate to your survey:

1. Aware

This is the first stage where potential customers become aware of a product or service. In your survey, 55% of respondents play games daily or several times a week, meaning that gaming advertisements should be placed on platforms where these gamers are most active, like social media or gaming websites, to raise awareness.

2. Appeal

Once aware, the product needs to appeal to the customer. For example, based on your survey, 24% of respondents prefer Role-Playing Games (RPGs), so a marketing campaign that focuses on the

immersive nature of an RPG could appeal to this group. Creating ads that highlight features aligned with their preferences will increase the likelihood of appealing to them.

3. Ask

At this stage, consumers seek more information about the product. Respondents in your survey who prefer playing alone (50%) or with friends (23%) may want to know if the game offers these modes. Marketers can provide detailed information about the game's features and gameplay modes that fit these interests to answer potential questions.

4. Act

After finding the product appealing, customers move to the action stage, where they make a purchase or take some other desired action. For example, students, who make up a large portion of your respondents, could be encouraged to act through special promotions like student discounts, driving them to buy the game.

5. Advocate

The final stage involves turning customers into advocates who will recommend the product to others. If gamers are satisfied with their experience (especially those who enjoy specific genres like RPGs or FPS), they might share their positive reviews or recommend the game to others in their social circles. Marketers could incentivize this advocacy by offering referral discounts or encouraging users to share their experiences on social media.

This approach ensures that marketing strategies follow the natural customer journey and meet consumers at every stage with the right messages.

3.1.5 Process of Selective Marketing

Selective marketing involves a systematic process that helps marketers focus their resources on the most profitable segments.

Step 1: Market Segmentation

The first step is dividing the market into distinct segments based on various criteria such as demographics, psychographics, behavior, and geography.

Step 2: Targeting

Once segments are identified, the next step is to choose one or more segments to target. The target segments are selected based on their size, potential for growth, and profitability.

Step 3: Positioning

Positioning refers to designing a product and its marketing messages in a way that resonates with the selected target segment. Marketers need to position the product effectively to highlight its unique value proposition.

Step 4: Creating Marketing Campaigns

Marketers then create tailored campaigns aimed at the target segment. These campaigns often utilize digital marketing tools such as social media, search engine optimization (SEO), email marketing, and influencer marketing.

Step 5: Evaluation and Feedback

After the campaigns are launched, the effectiveness is evaluated through data analytics. Marketers assess engagement levels, conversion rates, and other key performance indicators (KPIs) to refine future strategies.

3.1.6 Types of Selective Marketing

- Behavioural Targeting: Based on user behaviors like purchase history, web browsing, or app usage.
- Demographic Targeting: Aimed at specific demographic groups (e.g., age, gender, income).
- Geographic Targeting: Focused on a specific region or location.
- Psychographic Targeting: Targets consumers based on their lifestyles, interests, values, or attitudes.

Part II:

3.2 Literature Review:

1. **Antonaci, A. (2019)** studied the effects of gamification in Online Learning Environments: A systematic literature review in Heerlen, Netherlands, using a qualitative research methodology. The research focused on learner perceptions, engagement level and motivation types. Content analysis was used to analyse the data. The study found that Gen Z's game preferences were significantly shaped by targeted ads when aligned with personal goals. However, the sample size of the research was small as a result of which the participant groups were less diverse.

2. **Lin, Z. and all (2020)** investigated gamification and online impulse buying: The moderate effect of gender and age. The study was showed in China using online survey method. Key factors included impulse buying behaviour regardless the gender, age of the player. ANOVA and t-tests were applied to analyse the data. The major findings are the participants who preferred buying from e-commerce websites. The study concluded that gender and age does affect the buying behaviour but are yet not fully explored among different genres of games.

3. **Manuela, A. and all (2021)** studied the gamification and reputation: key determinants of e-commerce usage and repurchase intension which was conducted in Portugal using the experimental research. The findings focused on gamification factors in which ANOVA was used to analyse the data. The research revealed that participants continued to purchase again and again through online marketing. The study concluded that reputation is necessary to keep the game in demand though the research may not fully represent the entire scenarios.

4. **Lina Fatini, A. and all (2021)** conducted a longitudinal study on gamification elements in E-commerce which was held in Malaysia. The study explored consumer retention and user behaviour. Qualitative interviews, SEM and regression analysis were used for data analysis. The research found that gamers tend to buy more when they explore more on the sites which creates loyalty towards the developers. However, this finding focuses on short term benefits.

5. **Zhang, Z. (2023)** investigated the research on the development of recent game market held in America using quantitative survey. Game market trends, consumer behaviour and game

platform preference were the variables included, whereas descriptive and regression analysis were used. The study found that mobile gaming is highly in demand and it further concludes that among youngsters mobile gaming will keep on dominating. However, it only focused on consumer behaviour and ignores trends of market.

6. **Tai, H. Thanh Tu, T. (2023)** examined the impact of gamification on gen z impulse buying behaviour which was studied in Vietnam. It consists of mixed-methods i.e. survey and focus groups. Gamification elements were the main variables and structural equation modelling was used to access the data. The study found that perception of every individual was important during purchasing decisions. However, social media's role in marketing was limited.

7. **Liuyufeng, L. and all (2023)** investigated gamification enhances students' intrinsic motivation, perceptions of autonomy and relatedness, but minimal impact on competency. The research was conducted in Hong Kong, China using the mixed methods approach. It mainly focused on game mechanics and feedback loops. The study concluded that competition within the developers affects the buying behaviour of the students. However, the findings consisted a small sample size due to which there were limited academic students.

8. **Karmazinov, V. (2024)** evaluated the gamification if consumer loyalty programs which was performed in Ukraine, using online surveys. The research focused on consumer behaviour in which t-test and regression analysis was used for data analysing. The findings show that loyal customer tends to buy more games. The study concluded that those customers put a positive impact on the company but it lacks diversity in sample demographics.

9. **Adiguzel, S. (2024)** conducted a study to examine the effect of in-game advertising as a marketing technology on the purchasing behaviour on gen z. The research was carried out in Turkey, using a survey-based and experimental methodology. Key factors included in-game advertising, gen z attitudes, purchase intention, brand recall and gaming habits. Data analysis was performed using ANOVA and regression analysis. The study found that targeted marketing ads led to higher engagement with Gen Z, with personalized offers influencing their buying behaviour. However, the research concluded that while selective marketing is limited, it lacks a detailed analysis of regional behaviour differences.

10. **Gan, S. (2024)** explored the innovative digital marketing strategies in the gaming industry: A case study of love and deep space held in China using a case study. Variables included game market trends, consumer behaviour and game platform preference. To access the data, statistical and content analysis was used. The findings indicated how storytelling plays a vital role in gaming. It concluded that, emotional connection through story drives purchasing decisions, though it lacked long term effectiveness of such strategies.

Chapter 4:

Research Methodology

4.1 Research Problem:

The primary focus of this study is to understand the impact and consequences of selective marketing strategies on Generation Z (Gen Z) within the gaming industry in Surat city. Specifically, this research seeks to explore how gaming companies are targeting Gen Z consumers through selective marketing techniques and how these strategies influence their gaming behaviours, preferences, and purchasing decisions.

The central research problem can be broken down into the following key areas:

1. How do gaming companies use selective marketing to target Gen Z in Surat?
2. What marketing tactics are most effective in engaging Gen Z consumers in Surat's gaming market?
3. What are the consequences of these targeted marketing strategies on the behavior and purchasing decisions of Gen Z gamers in Surat?
4. How does selective marketing shape Gen Z's perceptions of gaming brands and influence their long-term loyalty to these brands?

The justification for this research stems from several key factors:

1. Gen Z's Influence on the Gaming Market:
    - Gen Z is the most digitally connected generation and constitutes a significant portion of the gaming audience, especially in growing markets like Surat. Understanding their behaviours, preferences, and responses to marketing is crucial for the future of the gaming industry. Gen Z has different consumption patterns compared to previous generations, often driven by social media, influencers, and personalized experiences.
2. The Rise of Selective Marketing:
    - Selective marketing has become a dominant approach in the gaming industry due to its ability to deliver personalized and targeted content. As the gaming market becomes more competitive, it is important to understand how gaming companies use selective marketing to connect with specific consumer segments, such as Gen Z, and tailor campaigns to resonate with their unique preferences and habits. However, limited

research has been conducted on the impact of selective marketing specifically in the context of Gen Z in Surat.

3. Lack of Focus on Surat's Gaming Market:
   - Surat, as a fast-growing metropolitan city with a young and tech-savvy population, has witnessed a rise in digital gaming and mobile gaming consumption. Despite the increasing popularity of gaming in Surat, there is a lack of focused research on how local gaming companies tailor their marketing strategies to cater to Gen Z in this particular region. Surat presents a unique cultural and socio-economic landscape, making it an ideal location to study how selective marketing impacts consumer behavior within the gaming sector.
4. Changes in Consumer Behavior Due to Digitalization:
   - As digital channels such as social media, influencers, and mobile platforms play a major role in shaping Gen Z's gaming choices, this study is crucial to understanding the consequences of digital marketing strategies. Researching the effectiveness of such approaches in Surat will provide valuable insights into how gaming companies can improve their marketing tactics and build lasting relationships with the Gen Z audience.
5. Practical Implications for Gaming Companies:
   - By exploring the impact of selective marketing on Gen Z's gaming behavior and purchasing decisions, this research can offer actionable recommendations to game developers and marketers operating in Surat. Understanding what works best for this demographic can help companies create more effective marketing campaigns, increase consumer engagement, and ultimately boost sales in the competitive gaming market.

4.2 Objectives of the Study:

<u>Primary Objectives:</u>

1. To assess the impact of selective marketing strategies on the gaming preferences of Gen Z in Surat.
2. To analyze the influence of selective marketing on the frequency of gaming among Gen Z in Surat.

3. To examine how selective marketing campaigns shape platform choices (e.g., mobile, PC, console) within the Gen Z demographic.
4. To study the relationship between selective marketing and in-game purchase behavior among Gen Z in Surat.
5. To investigate the role of targeted promotions and advertisements in driving gaming habits and decisions in Gen Z.
6. To explore the effect of selective marketing on brand loyalty and long-term engagement with gaming products among Gen Z.
7. To identify which marketing tactics (influencers, social media ads, etc.) are most effective in attracting Gen Z gamers in Surat.
8. To evaluate how selective marketing impacts Gen Z's spending on gaming-related content such as merchandise, subscriptions, or in-game items.
9. To examine how personalized marketing messages affect gaming habits and product choices in the Gen Z group.
10. To determine the overall effectiveness of selective marketing campaigns in engaging Gen Z in Surat's gaming industry.

Secondary Objectives:

1. To explore the impact of demographic factors (age, gender, occupation) on Gen Z's response to selective marketing in gaming.
2. To investigate how Gen Z perceives selective marketing techniques used by gaming companies in Surat.
3. To understand how social media platforms and influencers drive selective marketing campaigns targeting Gen Z in Surat.
4. To analyze the consequences of selective marketing on gaming brand image and consumer trust within Gen Z.
5. To assess whether selective marketing increases Gen Z's participation in online gaming communities and social platforms.
6. To evaluate the influence of selective marketing on the types of games played by Gen Z (e.g., competitive vs. casual).
7. To examine whether selective marketing leads to increased gaming time and frequency among Gen Z in Surat.

8. To investigate the ethical concerns related to targeted marketing practices in the gaming industry affecting Gen Z.
9. To explore the long-term consequences of selective marketing on Gen Z's relationship with gaming brands.
10. To assess if selective marketing promotes unhealthy gaming habits or excessive spending behaviors among Gen Z gamers.

4.3 Nature of Research:

This study falls under the category of Applied Research as it aims to address specific, practical problems faced by companies in the gaming industry when targeting Gen Z consumers through selective marketing strategies. Unlike basic research, which focuses on theoretical concepts and general principles, applied research seeks to provide actionable insights that can directly impact decision-making and business practices.

In the context of this study, the research will focus on practical aspects such as understanding consumer behavior, evaluating the effectiveness of marketing tactics, and offering recommendations to gaming companies on how to enhance their marketing strategies. The findings of this research will be used to help gaming companies refine their marketing efforts, improve engagement with Gen Z gamers, and optimize the use of digital marketing tools in Surat.

By focusing on real-world issues and offering data-driven insights, this research will contribute to the optimization of marketing strategies in the gaming industry, making it relevant to industry professionals and decision-makers looking to increase their market share and customer loyalty among Gen Z.

4.4 Type of Research Design:

This study will employ **descriptive research design** because it focuses on observing and describing the existing relationships and behaviors without manipulating variables. My study aims to examine how selective marketing influences Gen Z's gaming habits, preferences, and spending patterns in Surat, which aligns well with the goals of descriptive research. It allows you to gather detailed information through surveys or interviews to capture the current gaming behaviors and marketing influences without needing to control or alter conditions.

Unlike experimental or causal-comparative designs, descriptive research doesn't require changing any variables, making it ideal for exploring real-world gaming habits and marketing effects. This design helps to observe and document how selective marketing impacts Gen Z gamers, providing a clear snapshot of the current state in Surat's gaming industry. It enables me to analyze the relationships between demographic factors and gaming behaviors, offering a comprehensive understanding of the phenomenon you're studying.

4.5 Scope of the Research:

This study focuses on understanding the impact and consequences of selective marketing strategies on Gen Z gamers in Surat city, specifically within the gaming industry. The research will encompass several key areas, combining insights from both secondary research and primary data (survey results) to provide a comprehensive understanding of the gaming market and its marketing dynamics.

The scope of the research will include:

1. **Selective Marketing Strategies in the Gaming Industry:** The study will examine the various marketing tactics used by gaming companies to target Gen Z consumers. It will explore strategies such as influencer marketing, social media campaigns, in-game promotions, cross-media collaborations, and exclusive events. These strategies will be analysed in the context of their effectiveness in engaging Gen Z gamers and driving sales.

2. **Study of Cyberpunk 2077's Marketing Strategy:** The research will include a detailed analysis of the marketing strategy behind Cyberpunk 2077, focusing on how CD Projekt Red used selective marketing to target specific segments of gamers, especially Gen Z. The study will cover aspects such as teaser campaigns, influencer partnerships, community engagement, and cross-media promotions. The success and challenges faced during the pre-launch and post-launch phases will be explored, providing valuable insights into the effectiveness of these strategies in shaping consumer behavior.

3. **Survey Data Analysis:** The study will integrate data collected through a survey conducted among Gen Z gamers in Surat. The survey results will provide first-hand insights into consumer preferences, gaming habits, and the impact of marketing strategies on purchasing decisions. The data analysis will include:

    - Demographics of Gen Z gamers in Surat.

- Marketing preferences and the role of influencers and in-game promotions.
- Purchasing behaviors and factors influencing decision-making.
- Engagement with in-game advertisements and promotions.

4. **Impact of Influencers and Streamers:** The role of influencers and streamers in shaping Gen Z's gaming preferences will be a major area of focus. The research will explore how influencer partnerships and gaming live streams influence consumer engagement and purchasing behavior, with special emphasis on how these strategies can increase brand visibility and loyalty among Gen Z.
5. **Technological Impact on Marketing:** The study will explore the impact of emerging technologies such as augmented reality (AR), virtual reality (VR), and AI-driven personalization on marketing strategies. It will assess how these technologies influence game development and consumer engagement, specifically focusing on their role in selective marketing to Gen Z.
6. **Pre-launch and Post-launch Marketing Effectiveness:** The research will assess the most effective ways to market a game before and after its launch, using tactics like exclusive pre-launch events, early access, and social media promotions. The effectiveness of these strategies will be explored through the lens of Cyberpunk 2077's marketing campaign and survey insights.
7. **Geographical Focus – Surat:** The study will specifically focus on the gaming market in Surat, analyzing how local gaming communities respond to targeted marketing efforts. Surat, with its young and tech-savvy demographic, presents a unique opportunity to explore Gen Z's gaming behaviors in a growing urban market.

4.6 Data Collection:

- The data for this research will be **primary data**, collected through a survey distributed to Gen Z gamers in Surat.
- The survey will include both closed-ended questions (multiple choice, Likert scale) and open-ended questions to gather quantitative and qualitative insights on gaming preferences, marketing engagement, and purchasing behavior.

- Additionally, interviews with select gamers may be conducted to gain deeper understanding, while observational data from platforms like Twitch and YouTube will provide insights into the role of influencers and streamers in marketing.
- This primary data will be analysed to identify key trends in how selective marketing influences Gen Z gamers in Surat.

4.6.1 Sample Size:

- The survey collected responses from a total of **103 participants** from Surat city, representing a diverse range of age groups and gaming interests within the Gen Z demographic.
- While the majority of respondents are within the typical Gen Z age range (18-24 years), the sample includes gamers of varying ages and interests, ensuring a broad perspective on how different gaming preferences and marketing strategies resonate with this group.
- The varied background of the respondents allows for a more comprehensive analysis of how selective marketing influences purchasing behavior, engagement, and satisfaction with marketing efforts across different interests and gaming habits within Gen Z.

4.6.2 Sampling Method:

For my study on the "Impact and Consequences of Selective Marketing in Gen Z in the Gaming Industry in Surat City," the sampling method chosen is **convenience sampling**, which is a type of **non-probability sampling**. This method involves selecting participants who are easiest to reach or most accessible, rather than randomly selecting individuals from the entire population. In this case, convenience sampling will allow me to target Gen Z gamers in Surat who are readily available or willing to participate in the study, such as those in local gaming communities, social media groups, or gaming events.

The advantage of convenience sampling is that it is time-friendly and cost-efficient, enabling me to gather data quickly from a specific subset of the population without the need for extensive resources. However, since this method does not ensure that every individual in the target population has an equal chance of being selected, the findings may not be fully representative of the entire Gen Z demographic in Surat. Despite this limitation, convenience sampling is often used in descriptive studies like yours, especially when the research aims to provide an initial understanding of a phenomenon rather than draw conclusions about the entire population.

4.6.3 Sampling Frame:

- The sampling frame for this study will consist of active gamers from a variety of online communities and gaming platforms in Surat city.
- These will include popular social media platforms (such as Instagram, Facebook, and Twitter), streaming services (like Twitch and YouTube), and gaming media outlets where gamers regularly engage in discussions, share content, and follow influencers.
- Additionally, gaming forums and Discord channels will be used to identify participants who are actively involved in gaming and marketing-related conversations. These platforms provide access to a targeted group of participants who are familiar with gaming-related marketing strategies and are likely to provide relevant insights into their preferences and behaviors.

4.6.4 Sampling Element:

- The sampling element for this study will be active gamers who regularly engage with gaming-related content across various online platforms, including social media (such as Instagram, Facebook, and Twitter), gaming forums, and streaming services like Twitch and Discord.
- These gamers, who actively participate in the gaming community and are exposed to gaming marketing campaigns, will be the focus of this research. Their gaming habits, purchasing behaviors, and opinions on marketing strategies will be analysed to understand the impact of selective marketing on their preferences and decision-making processes.

4.6.5 Survey Method:

- The survey method used in this study involved the administration of an **online questionnaire**.
- The questionnaire was designed to gather insights from Gen Z gamers in Surat about their gaming habits, preferences, and responses to marketing strategies in the gaming industry. The online format allowed for efficient data collection from a wide range of participants, ensuring that the survey reached gamers across different social media platforms, gaming forums, and streaming services.
- This method enabled the collection of both quantitative and qualitative data, offering a comprehensive view of gamers' behaviors and perceptions regarding selective marketing in the gaming industry.

4.6.6 Survey Tool:

- The survey tool will consist of a structured online questionnaire with predefined questions designed to gather specific insights into gamers' behaviors and perceptions of marketing strategies in the gaming industry. The questionnaire will be distributed online to ensure efficient data collection, allowing for consistent and easy analysis of both quantitative and qualitative responses.

4.6.7 Response Rate:

- The response rate for this survey was 104 completed responses.
- The survey was distributed through various online platforms such as social media, gaming forums, and streaming services, targeting Gen Z gamers in Surat.
- The response rate reflects a good level of engagement from the targeted audience, providing valuable data for analyzing gamers' behaviors and perceptions of marketing strategies.
- Given the active participation of respondents, the results are expected to offer relevant and actionable insights into gaming marketing trends.

4.6.8 Pilot Survey:

- Before conducting the main survey, a pilot survey was carried out with a small group of respondents to test the effectiveness of the questionnaire. This pretesting phase helped identify any issues with question clarity, wording, and the overall structure of the survey.
- Feedback from the pilot survey allowed for necessary revisions to ensure the questionnaire accurately captured the intended data and was easy for respondents to understand.
- The results of the pilot survey were not included in the final analysis but were crucial in refining the survey tool for better reliability and validity.

4.7 Data Analysis:

The data collected from the survey will be analysed using a combination of descriptive statistics and correlation analysis. Descriptive statistics will be used to summarize and present the data in a clear and concise manner, providing insights into key trends such as the most common gaming habits, preferences, and marketing strategies that resonate with Gen Z gamers. Measures such as frequencies, percentages, and averages will be applied to highlight patterns in responses.

Additionally, correlation analysis will be utilized to explore the relationship between different marketing strategies (such as influencer marketing, in-game promotions, and social media campaigns) and consumer behavior (including purchasing decisions and brand loyalty). By identifying these relationships, the analysis will help to determine how specific marketing tactics influence gaming preferences, engagement, and overall consumer satisfaction. These analytical techniques will enable a thorough understanding of the impact of selective marketing on Gen Z gamers in Surat, providing valuable insights for game developers and marketers.

4.8 List of Hypothesis:

The hypotheses for this study include:

H1: To study the relationship between gender and the amount of time spent gaming on a weekly basis.

H2: To analyze how an individual's occupation influences the frequency of their gaming patterns.

H3: To examine the correlation between gamers' age, gender, and the frequency of their gaming habits.

H4: To examine the correlation between an individual's occupation and the amount of time they spend on gaming.

4.9 Limitations of the Study:

1) **Sampling Bias**: The use of convenience sampling means that the respondents were selected based on their accessibility and willingness to participate, which may not fully represent the diversity of the Gen Z gamer population in Surat. This could limit the generalizability of the results to the broader population of Gen Z gamers.
2) **Geographical Focus**: The research is specifically focused on gamers in Surat, which may not reflect the gaming behaviors, preferences, and responses to marketing strategies in other regions or countries. The findings may therefore be more relevant to Surat's urban gaming community and may not be applicable to rural areas or other urban centres.
3) **Self-Reported Data**: As the data collection relies on self-reported surveys, respondents might be influenced by personal biases, such as social desirability bias or inaccurate recall, which could impact the reliability and validity of the findings.
4) **Limited Scope of Marketing Strategies**: The study focuses primarily on influencer marketing, social media marketing, and in-game promotions, which are common strategies

used in the gaming industry. However, this may exclude other marketing tactics, such as traditional advertisements, word-of-mouth, or event-based marketing, which may also have an impact on Gen Z gamers.

5) **Time Constraints**: The study was conducted over a limited period, which may not capture seasonal trends or changing preferences in the gaming market. Gaming trends and marketing effectiveness can shift rapidly, and this study may not account for those dynamics.
6) **Exclusion of Non-Gamers**: Since the study only focuses on active gamers, it does not take into account the views of potential gamers or individuals who are not engaged with gaming, which could provide additional insights into why certain marketing strategies are successful or not.
7) **Platform-Specific Bias**: The research is based on data from online platforms, such as social media and gaming forums, which may exclude the opinions of individuals who do not actively engage in these platforms, potentially skewing the results towards more digitally connected gamers.
8) **Limited Depth of Survey Questions**: While the survey includes both quantitative and qualitative questions, it may not fully capture the nuanced motivations behind game purchasing decisions or long-term consumer behavior. More in-depth qualitative research (such as focus groups or interviews) could have provided deeper insights into these behaviors.

Chapter 5:

Data Analysis & Findings

5.1 Data Analysis:

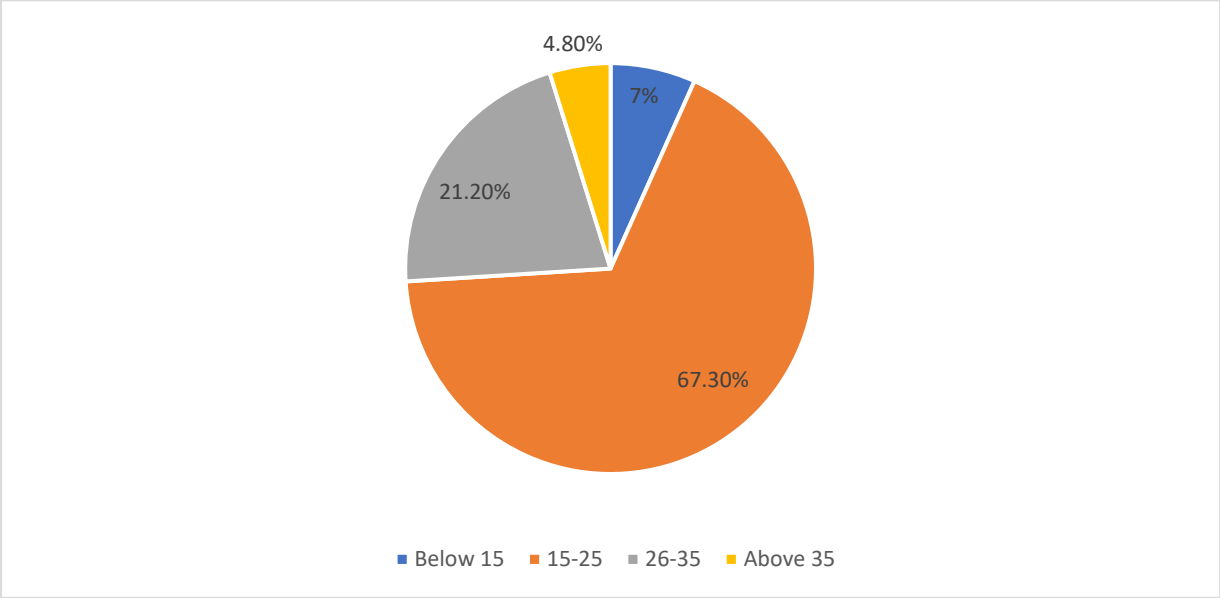
Section 1: Demographic Information:

Q. What is your age?

Table No. 12

Age	Frequency	Percentage
Below 15	7	6.70%
15 – 25	70	67.30%
26 – 35	22	21.2%
Above 35	5	4.80%
Total	104	100.00%

Chart No. 1



Interpretation:

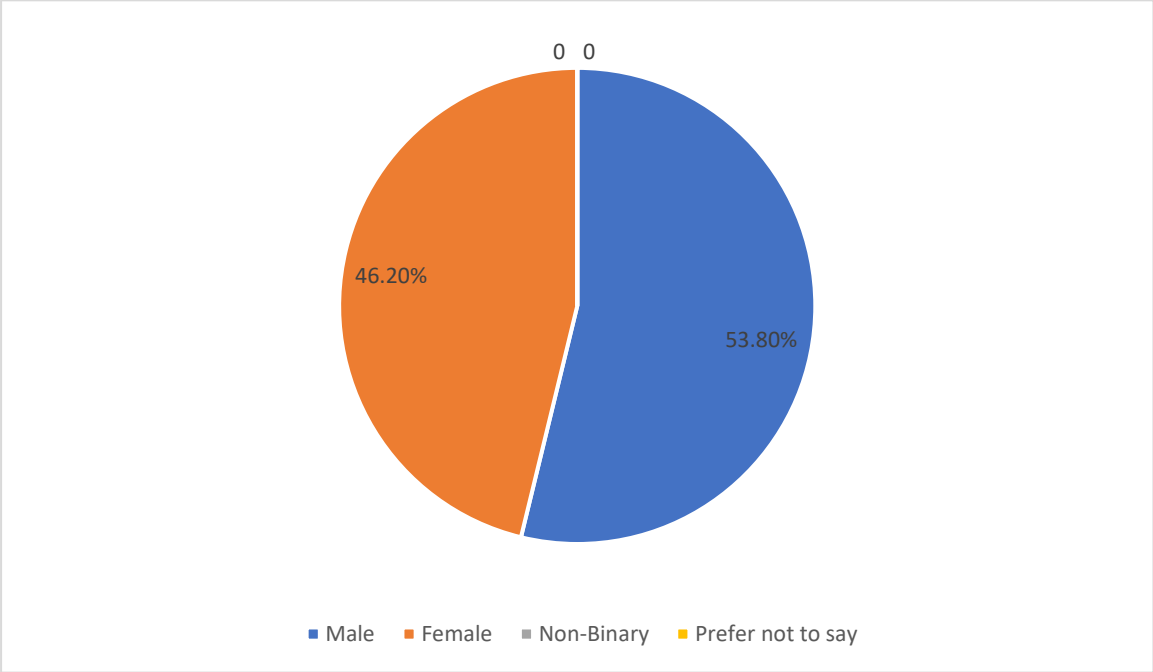
The age distribution of survey respondents shows that the majority of gamers fall within the 15-25 age group, accounting for 67.3% of the sample. This is followed by the 26-35 age group with 21.2%, indicating a strong focus on younger gamers. A smaller proportion of respondents are in the Below 15 (6.7%) and Above 35 (4.8%) categories. These results suggest that the gaming community in Surat is predominantly composed of young adults, aligning with the typical demographic of Gen Z gamers.

Q. What is your gender?

Table No. 13

Gender	Frequency	Percentage
Male	56	52.30%
Female	48	47.70%
Non-Binary	0	0
Prefer not to say	0	0
Total	104	100.00%

Chart No. 2



Interpretation:

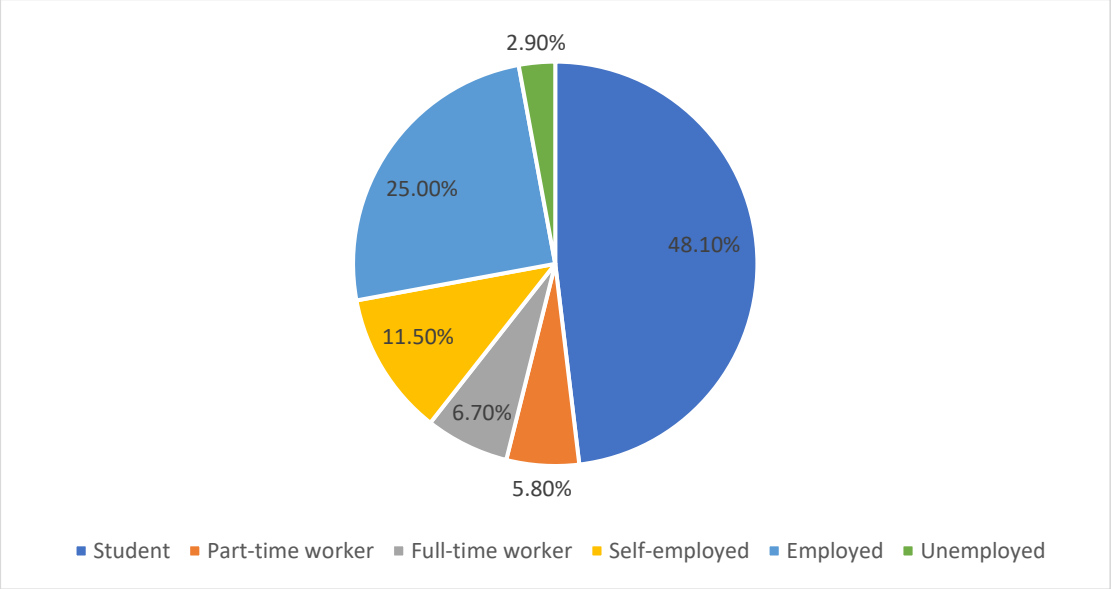
From the above chart, it can be seen that the gender distribution among the respondents is quite balanced, with 52.3% of the participants identifying as male and 47.7% identifying as female. This indicates a fairly equal representation of both genders in the gaming community in Surat, suggesting that gaming is a popular activity across genders.

Q. What is your occupation?

Table No. 14

Occupation	Frequency	Percentage
Student	50	48.10%
Part-time worker	6	5.80%
Full-time worker	7	6.70%
Self-employed	12	11..50%
Employed	26	25%
Unemployed	3	2.90%
Total	104	100.00%

Chart No. 3



Interpretation:

Based on the chart above, it is clear that a significant portion of the respondents are students, making up 48.1% of the sample. This is followed by employed individuals at 25%, with self-employed participants accounting for 11.5%. The survey also shows smaller groups of part-time workers (5.8%), full-time workers (6.7%), and unemployed individuals (2.9%).

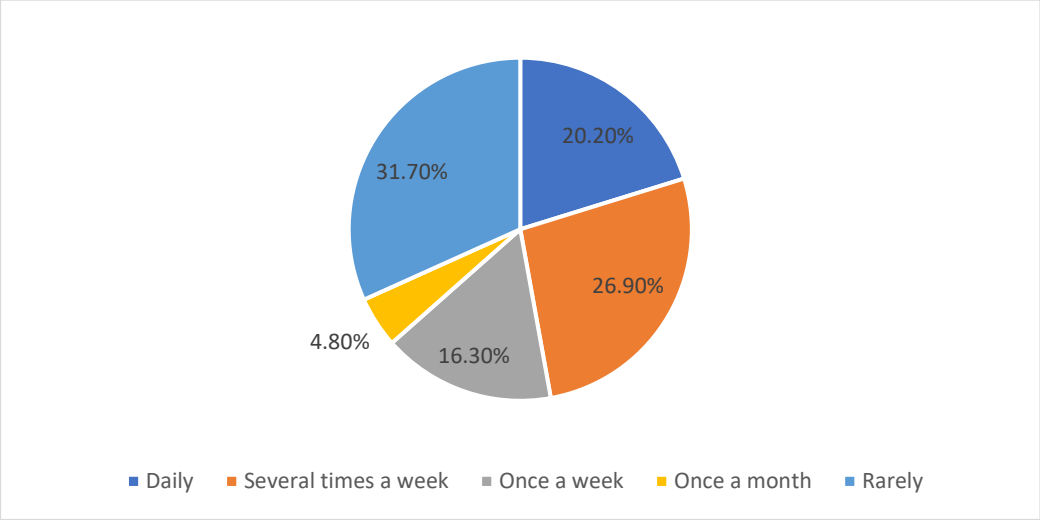
Section 2: Gaming Habits

Q. How often do you play games?

Table No. 15

	Frequency	Percentage
Daily	21	20.20%
Several times a week	28	26.90%
Once a week	17	16.30%
Once a month	5	4.80%
Rarely	33	31.80%
Total	104	100.00%

Chart No. 4



Interpretation:

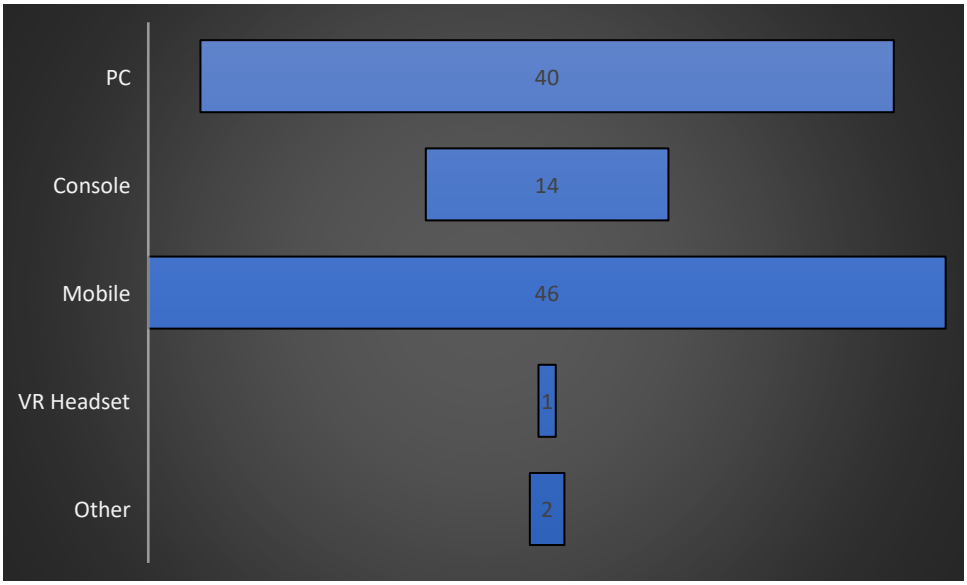
From the above chart, it is evident that daily gaming is more common among males (16) than females (5), with a total of 21 respondents gaming daily. Once a month is the most frequent gaming frequency overall, with 33 participants, particularly dominated by females (23). The "rarely" category has the highest number of respondents, with 21 males and 7 females, totalling 28 individuals who play games infrequently. These findings suggest that while daily gaming is more popular among males, there is a larger proportion of gamers, especially females, who game on a less frequent basis, indicating varying levels of engagement within the community.

Q. What is your primary game platform?

Table No. 16

Platform	Frequency	Percentage
PC	40	39%
Console (XBOX, PlayStation, etc)	14	14%
Mobile	46	45%
VR Headset	1	1%
Other	2	2%
Total	103	100.00%

Chart No. 5



Interpretation:

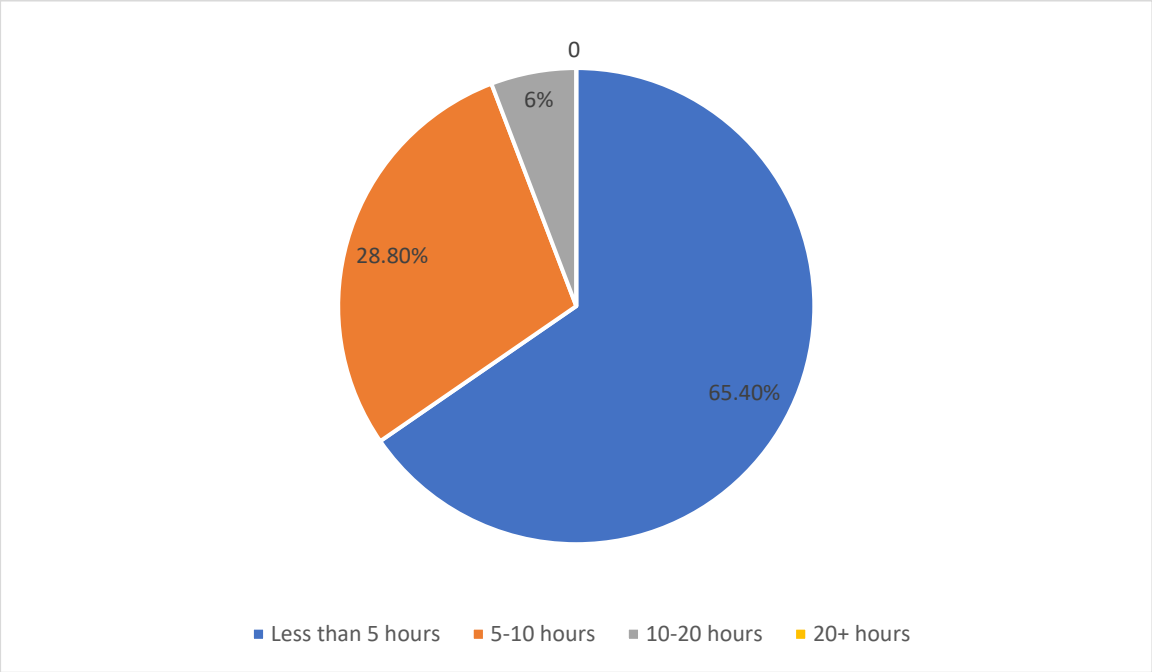
From the above chart, it is clear that the most popular gaming platform among the respondents is mobile, with 45% of participants choosing it as their primary platform. PC gaming follows closely, with 39% of respondents, while console gaming (Xbox, PlayStation, etc.) accounts for 14%. The use of VR headsets and other platforms is minimal, comprising only 1% and 2%, respectively.

Q. How many hours do you typically spend gaming per week?

Table No. 17

	Frequency	Percentage
Less than 5 hours	68	65.40%
5-10 hours	30	28.80%
10-20 hours	6	5.80%
20+ hours	0	0%
Total	104	100.00%

Chart No. 6



Interpretation:

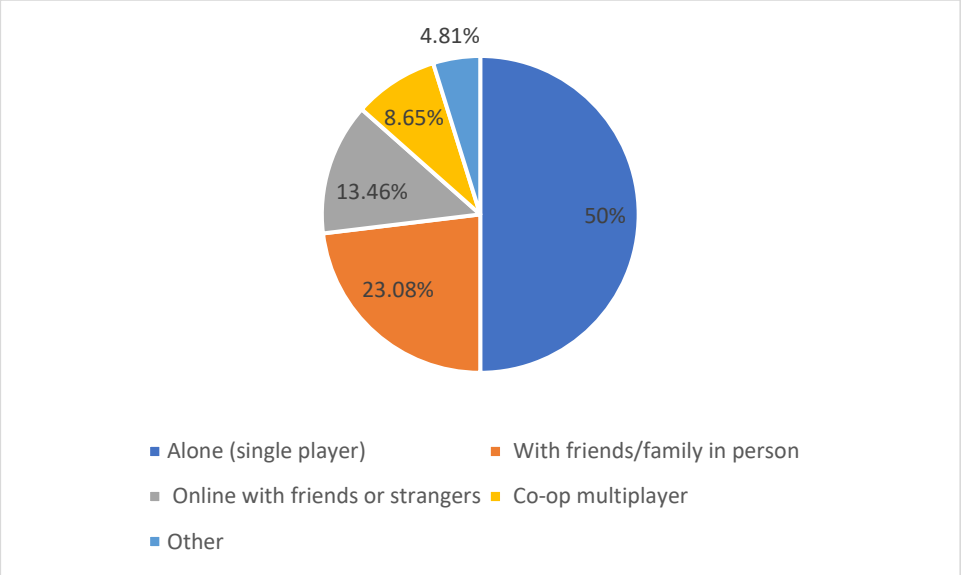
From the above chart, it is evident that the majority of respondents, 65.4%, spend less than 5 hours per week gaming. A smaller group of 28.8% gamers engage in gaming for 5-10 hours weekly, while only 5.8% game for 10-20 hours per week. Notably, no respondents reported gaming for more than 20 hours per week, indicating that gaming habits in Surat are generally moderate. This suggests that marketing strategies should be tailored to cater to casual gamers who spend limited hours gaming each week.

Q. How do you usually play video games?

Table No. 18

	Frequency	Percentage
Alone (Single Player)	52	50%
With friends/family in person	24	23.08%
Online with friends or strangers	14	13.46 %
Co-op Multiplayer	9	8.65%
Other	5	4.81%
Total	104	100.00%

Chart No. 7



Interpretation:

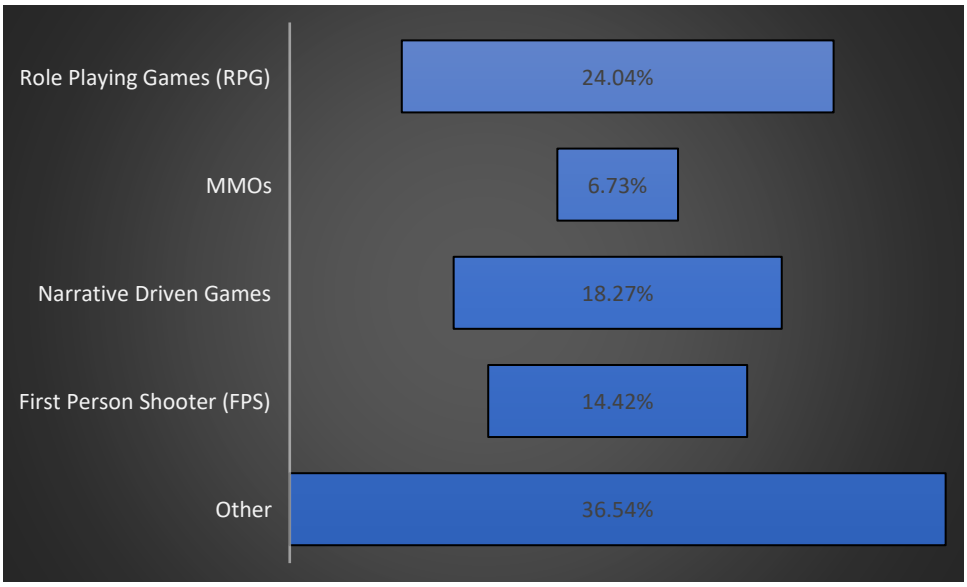
The table shows that the majority of participants (50%) prefer playing games alone (single-player), indicating a strong inclination toward solo gaming experiences. Playing with friends or family in person follows with 23.08%, while a smaller portion of players enjoy online gaming with friends or strangers (13.46%) and co-op multiplayer (8.65%). Only a small percentage (4.81%) reported engaging in other types of gaming experiences, highlighting that social gaming experiences, whether offline or online, play a secondary role compared to solo play.

Q. Which genre of game you prefer to play?

Table No. 19

Genre	Frequency	Percentage
Role Playing Games (RPG)	25	24.04%
MMOs	7	6.73%
Narrative Driven Games	19	18.27%
First Person Shooter (FPS)	15	14.42%
Other	38	36.54%
Total	104	100.00%

Chart No. 8



Interpretation:

The table reveals that the most popular genre among participants is Role Playing Games (RPG), accounting for 24.04% of the responses, followed by Narrative Driven Games (18.27%) and First Person Shooter (FPS) games (14.42%). A smaller portion of participants enjoy MMOs (6.73%). However, a significant 36.54% of respondents listed other genres, suggesting a diverse range of gaming preferences beyond the specified categories.

Section 3: Marketing Exposure:

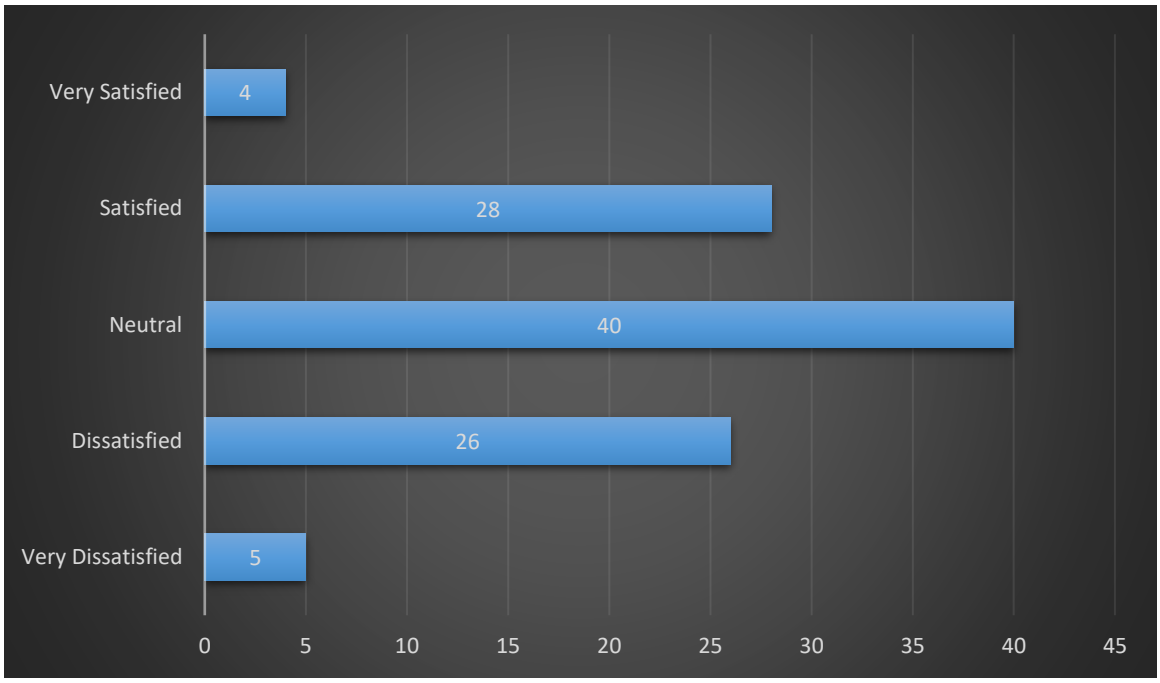
Table No. 20

Questions	Very Dis-satisfied	Dis-satisfied	Neutral	Satisfied	Very Satisfied
1. The gaming advertisements I see are generally aligned with my personal preferences and gaming habits.	5	26	40	28	4
2. The personalization of gaming ads (based on my preferences) has a positive impact on my gaming experience.	8	27	45	20	3
3. I am satisfied with the current gaming experience on my preferred platform (e.g., PC, console, mobile).	12	21	34	28	3
4. The gaming ads I encounter online are relevant to my interests.	6	27	39	24	7
5. I see gaming ads specifically targeting my demographic (Gen Z).	9	24	47	16	7

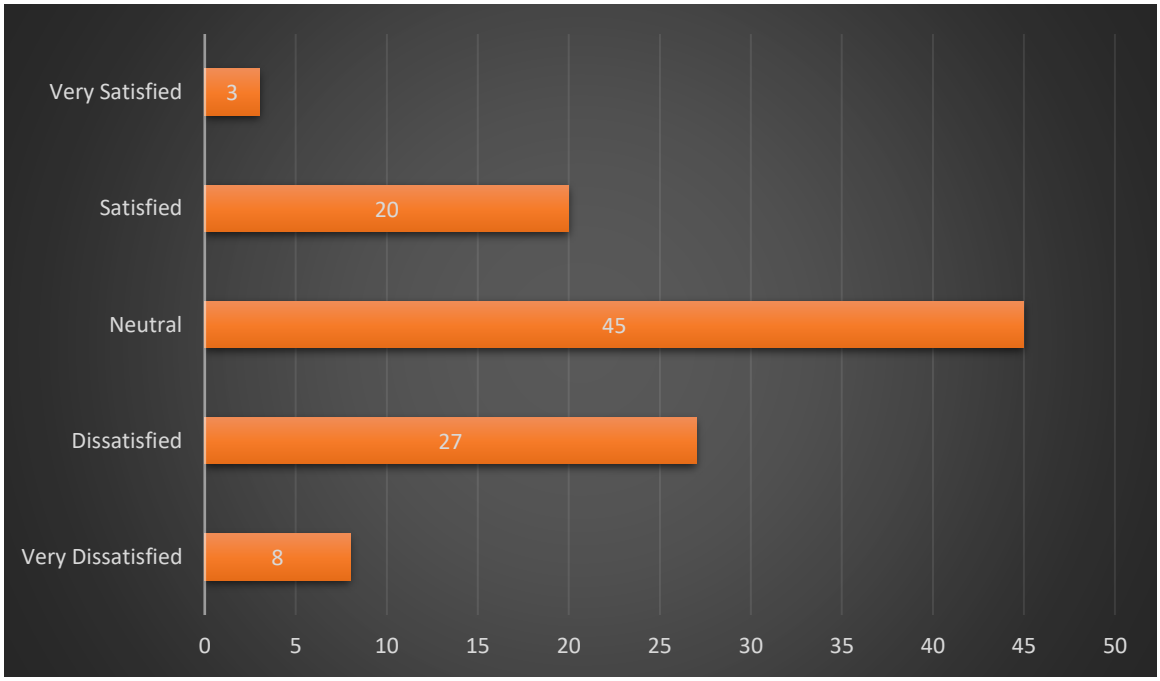
Bifurcations of the table in charts:

Chart No. 9

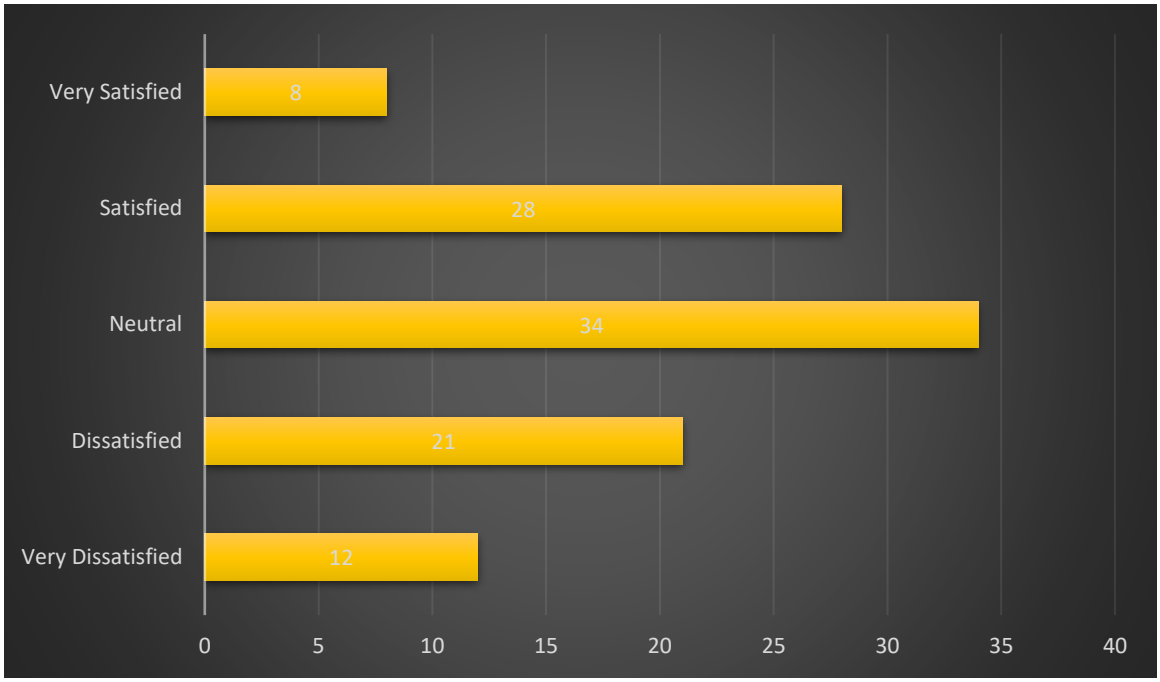
Q. I am satisfied with the gaming advertisements I see which are generally aligned with my personal preferences and gaming habits. (Chart No. 9.1)



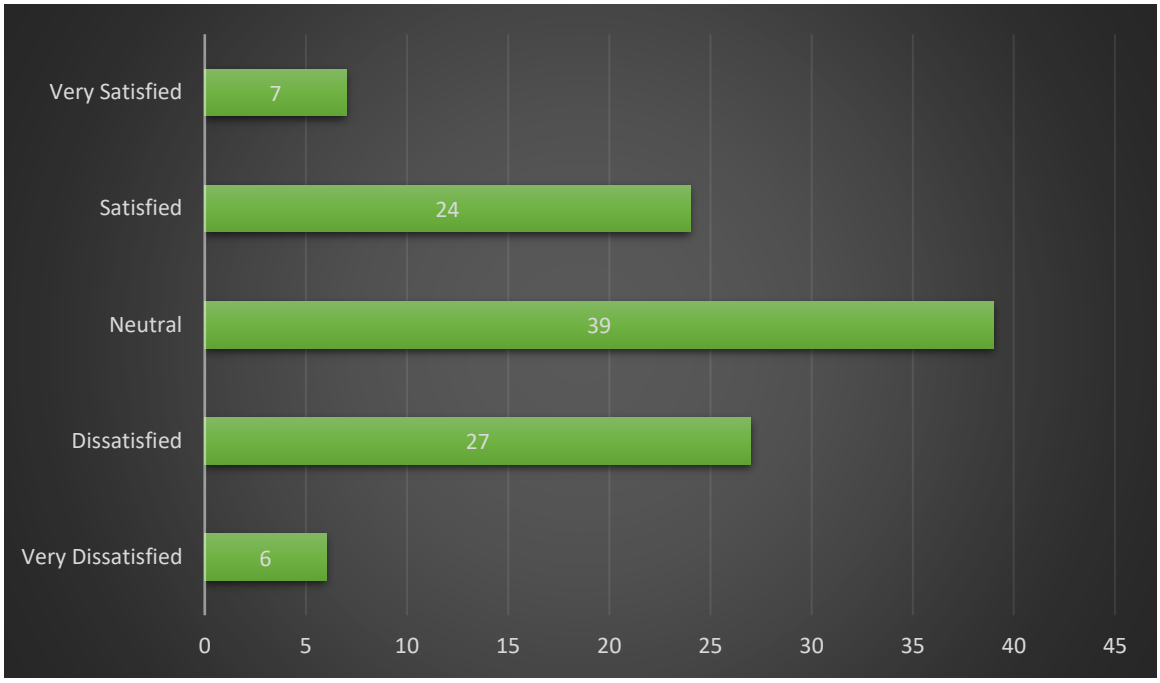
Q. The personalization of gaming ads (based on my preferences) has a positive impact on my gaming experience. (Chart No. 9.2)



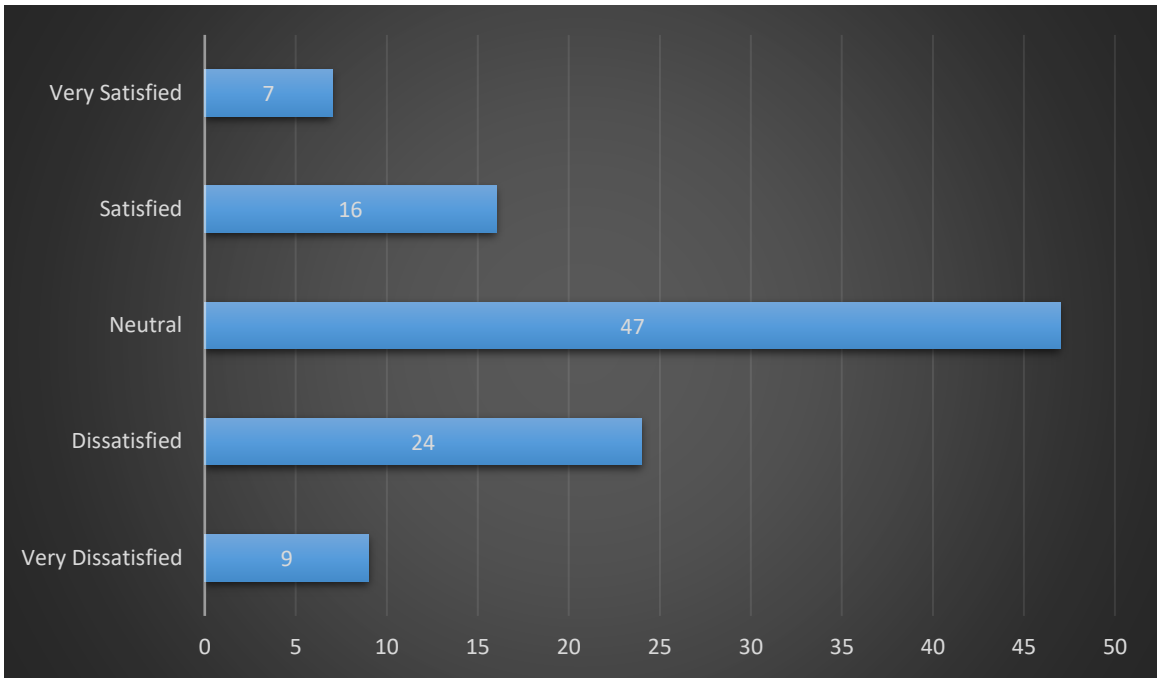
Q. I am satisfied with the current gaming experience on my preferred platform (e.g., PC, console, mobile). (Chart No. 9.3)



Q. The gaming ads I encounter online are relevant to my interests. (Chart No. 9.4)



Q. I see gaming ads specifically targeting my demographic (Gen Z). (Chart No. 9.5)



Interpretation:

The responses from the survey indicate that there is mixed satisfaction with the alignment and personalization of gaming advertisements. A significant portion of participants (66%) expressed being either neutral or dissatisfied with how gaming ads match their personal preferences and gaming habits. Additionally, while 45% of respondents were neutral about the impact of personalized ads on their gaming experience, a notable 35% felt dissatisfied, suggesting that the current level of ad personalization isn't effectively enhancing their gaming experience. This implies that gaming companies need to refine their ad targeting strategies to ensure they resonate more with the individual preferences of gamers.

On the other hand, there is a relatively higher level of satisfaction with the relevance of gaming ads, as 63% of respondents felt the advertisements, they encounter are relevant to their interests. However, when it comes to ads targeting Gen Z, only 16% expressed satisfaction, while 47% were neutral. This indicates that while the industry is somewhat successful in creating relevant ads, it still has room to improve in terms of demographic targeting, particularly for the Gen Z audience. Overall, these findings suggest that gaming companies need to further enhance their personalization efforts and develop more targeted, engaging advertising strategies to better connect with their audience.

Section 4: Brand and Product Perception:

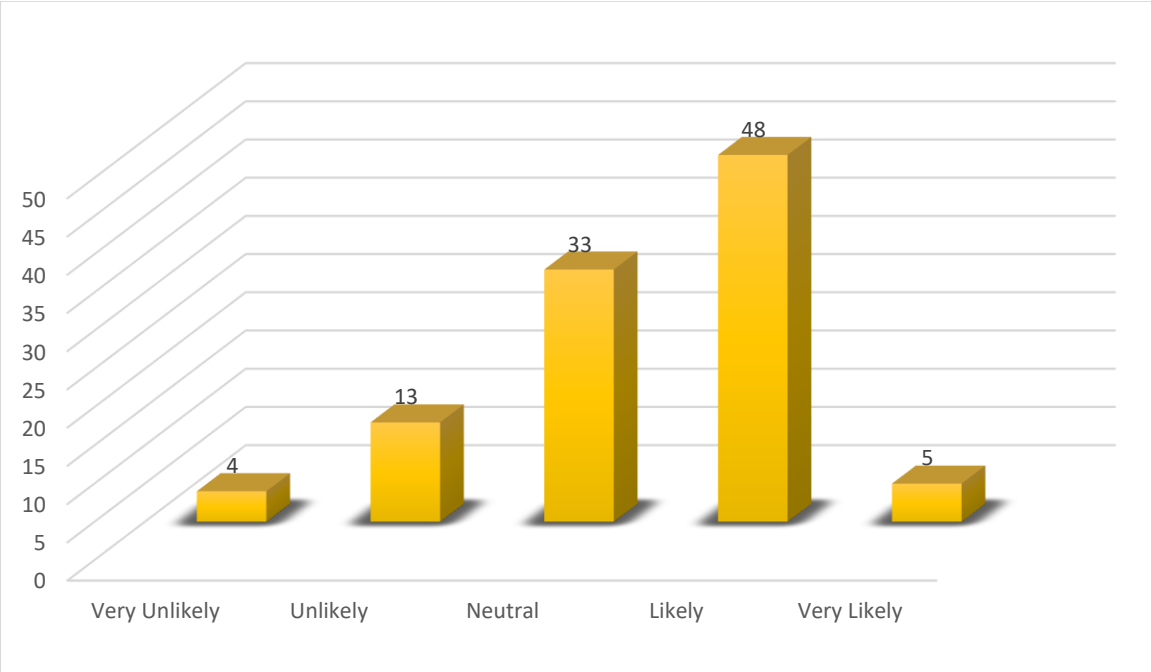
Table No. 21

Questions	Very Likely	Likely	Neutral	Unlikely	Very Unlikely
1. Selective marketing influences my decision to buy a game (in a good or a bad way).	5	48	33	13	4
2. I support a game developer or publisher that engages in ethical marketing practices (e.g., honest advertising, no deceptive ads).	11	19	54	17	2
3. Personalized gaming franchises create a sense of excitement about new releases.	12	33	35	20	3
4. Targeted gaming franchises make me feel like my gaming experience is more personalized.	8	41	38	11	5
5. I try a game based on a developer's reputation, even if I've never heard of the game before?	8	33	34	21	2
6. Seeing gaming advertisements makes me feel more excited for new upcoming games.	9	26	48	15	5

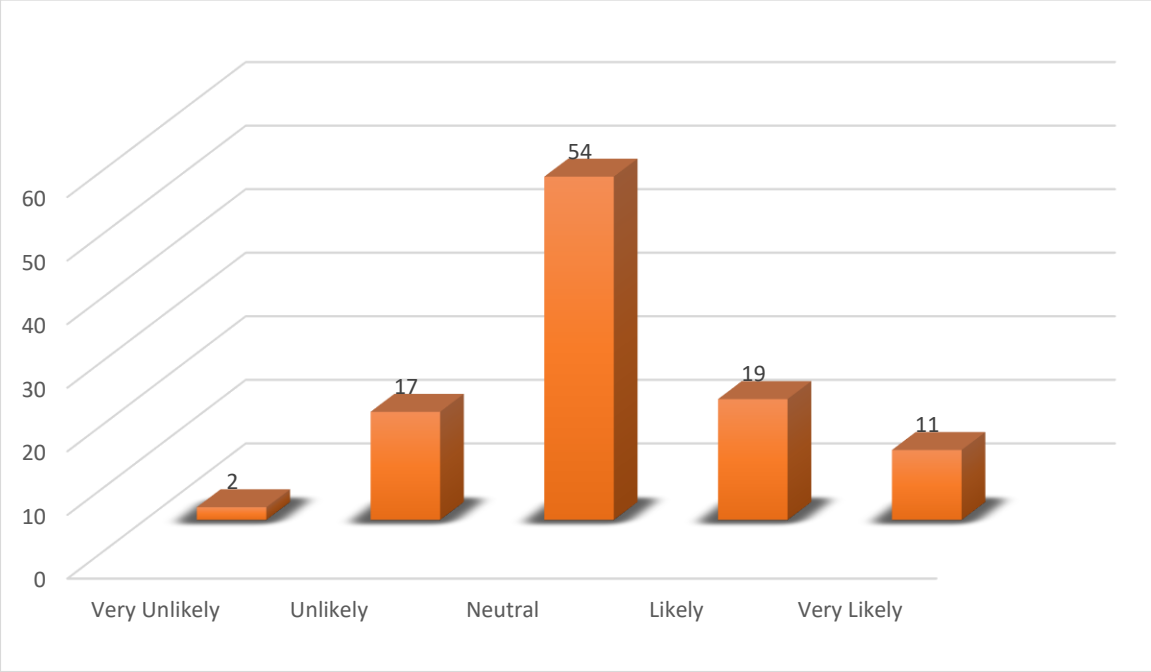
Bifurcations of the table in charts:

Chart No. 10

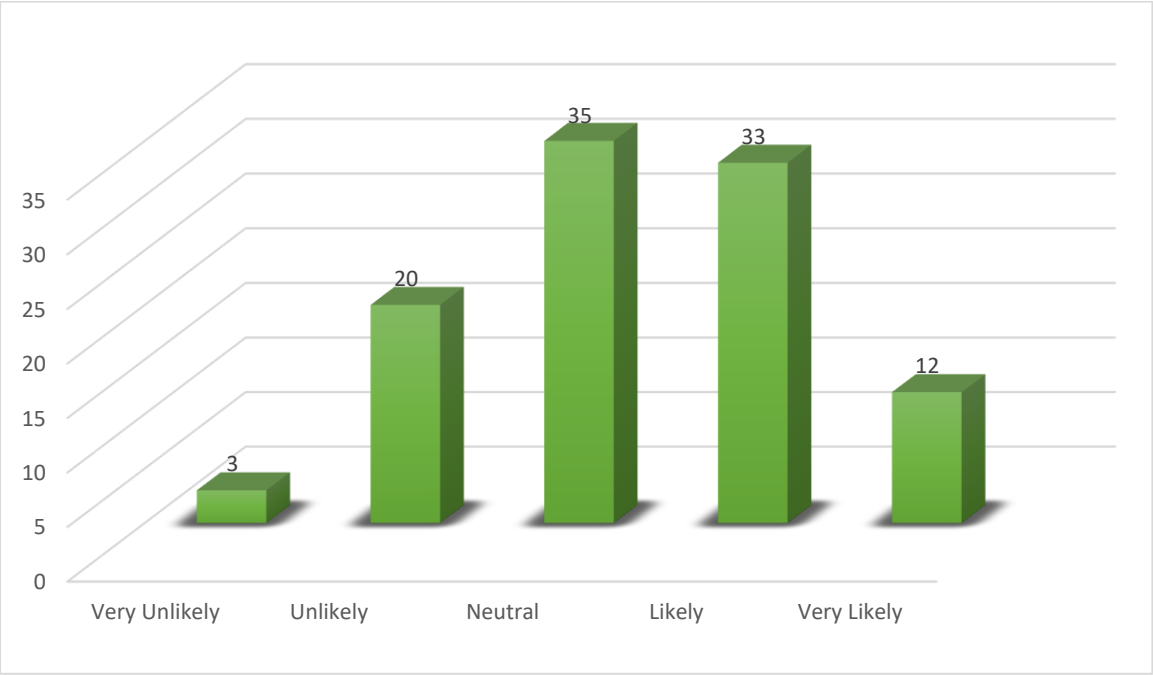
Q. Selective marketing influences my decision to buy a game(in a good or a bad way). (Chart No. 10.1)



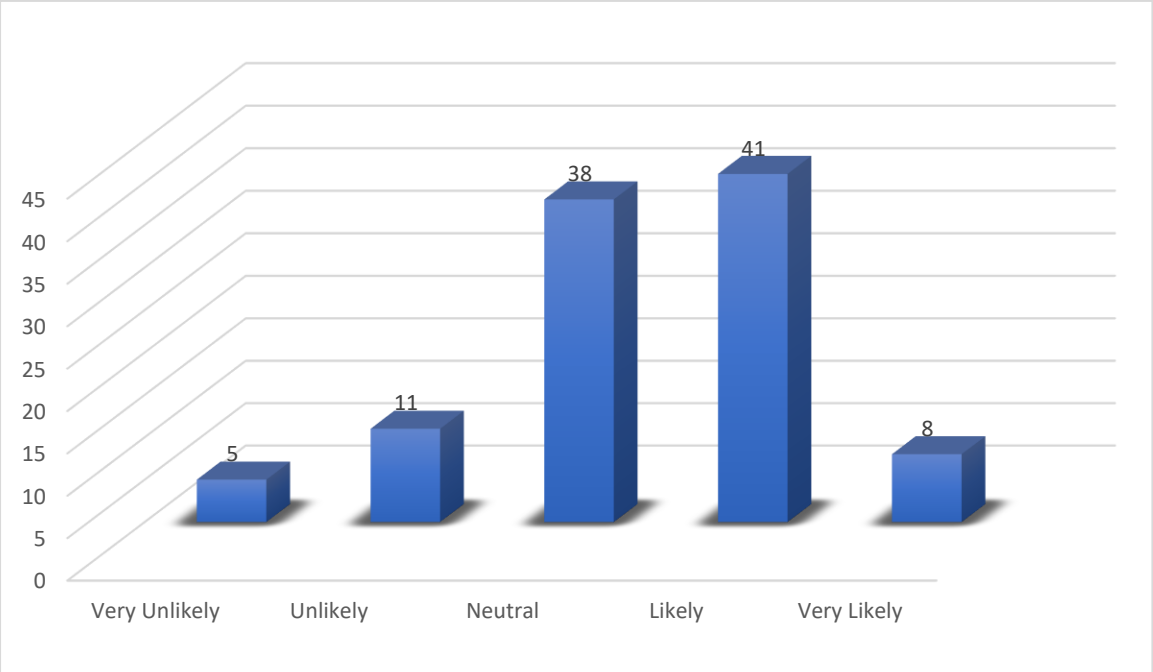
Q. I support a game developer or publisher that engages in ethical marketing practices (e.g., honest advertising, no deceptive ads). (Chart No. 10.2)



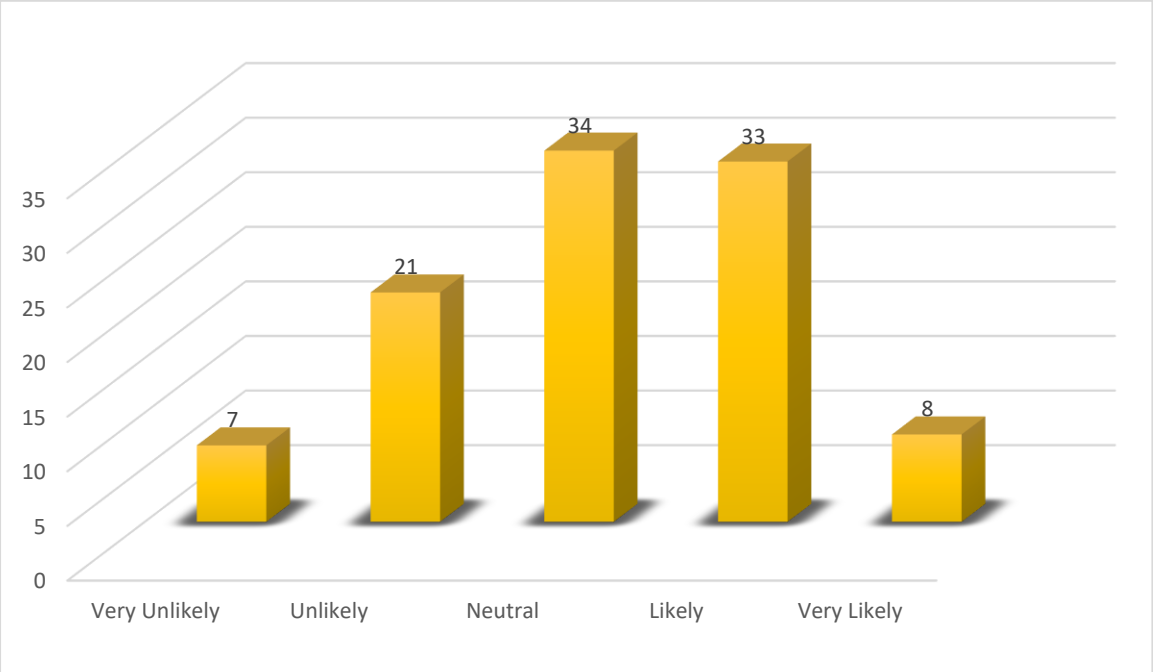
Q. Personalized gaming franchises create a sense of excitement about new releases. (Chart No. 10.3)



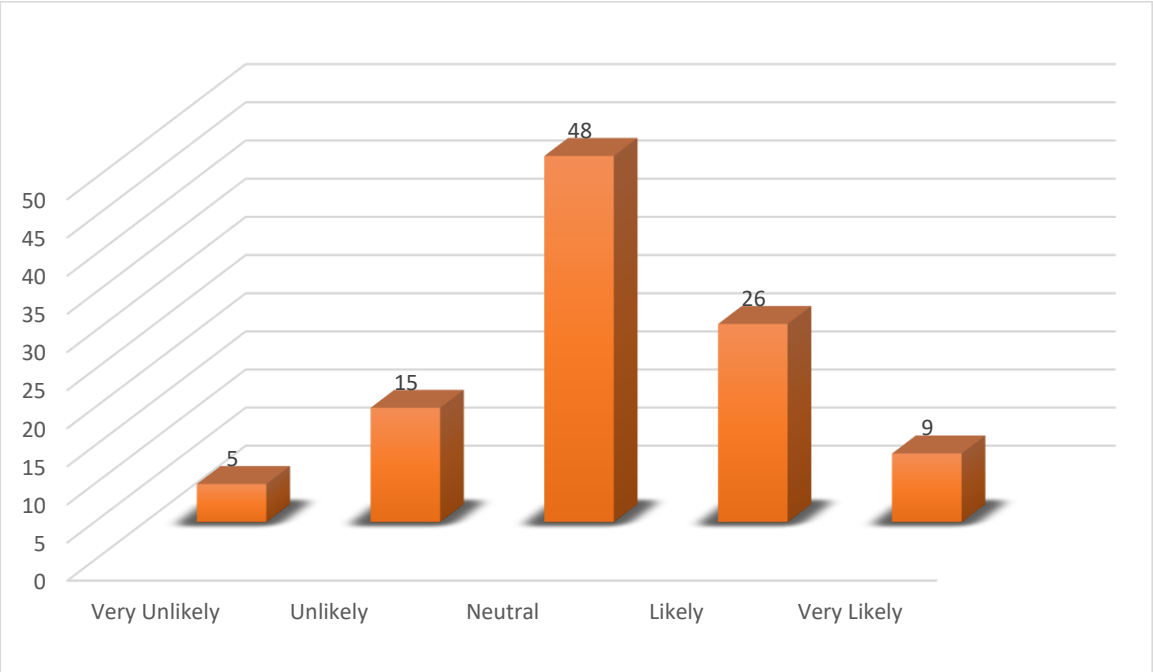
Q. Targeted gaming franchises make me feel like my gaming experience is more personalized. (Chart No. 10.4)



Q. I try a game based on a developer's reputation, even if I've never heard of the game before? (Chart No. 10.5)



Q. Seeing gaming advertisements makes me feel more excited for new upcoming games. (Chart No. 10.6)



Interpretation:

From the above table and charts, the survey responses reveal insights into how selective marketing and personalized strategies affect gaming behavior. When asked if selective marketing influences their decision to buy a game, 48% of respondents stated they were likely to be influenced, while 33% were neutral, indicating that while many gamers are impacted by marketing, there is still a group that remains indifferent.

Regarding ethical marketing practices, a majority of 54% were neutral about supporting developers based on honesty in advertising, but 11% were very likely to support ethical marketing. When it comes to personalized gaming franchises, 45% of respondents feel likely that they create excitement about new releases, while 38% agreed that targeted franchises make their experience feel more personalized. Additionally, 33% of participants would try a game based on the developer's reputation, even without prior knowledge of the game, indicating the importance of trust and developer image. Lastly, 35% feel neutral about gaming ads increasing excitement for new games, showing that while some gamers are motivated by ads, others are less affected by them. These findings suggest that while personalized marketing can influence gaming choices, there is still a portion of gamers who remain indifferent or less responsive to such strategies.

Section 5: Impact of gaming choices and behavior:

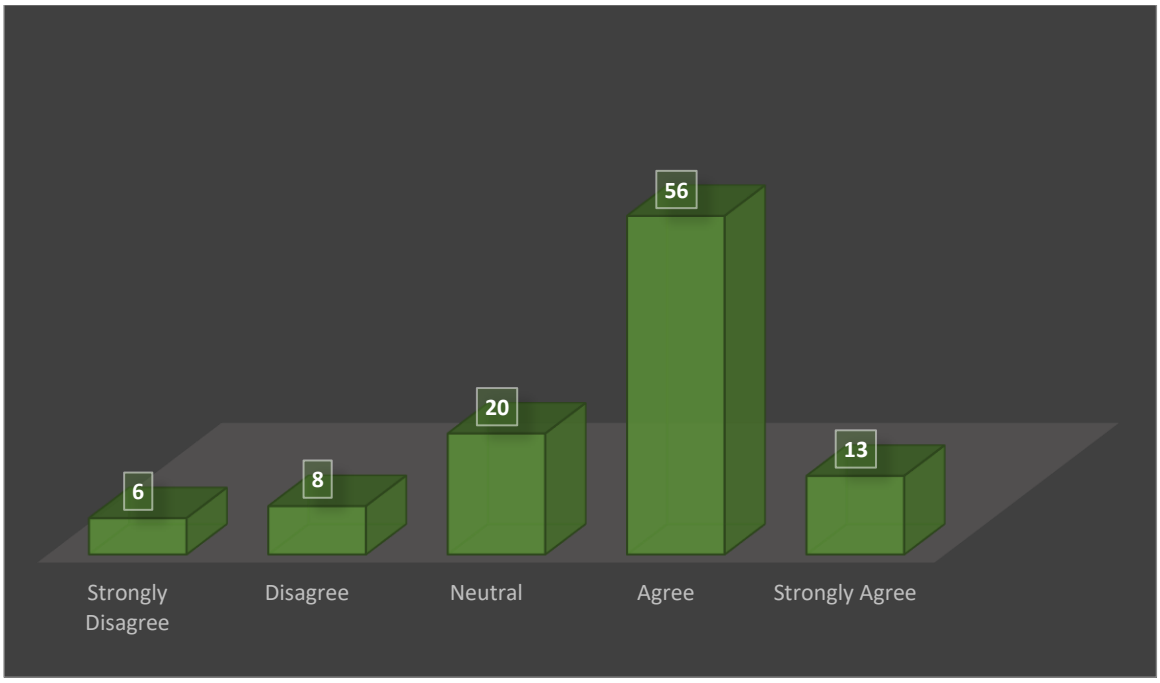
Table No. 22

Questions	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly Agree
1. The use of memes, trends, or viral content in marketing campaigns influences my decision to engage with a game.	6	8	20	56	13
2. I have noticed a positive change in my gaming preferences due to targeted marketing campaigns.	4	17	46	28	8
3. I often purchase games or in-game purchases (microtransactions) based on marketing that resonates with my interests and personality.	9	16	32	39	7
4. I feel more inclined to try a game if the advertisement or campaign features a popular social media influencer or celebrity.	12	15	38	32	6
5. Selective marketing campaigns often make me feel more connected to a gaming community or culture.	6	16	45	29	7

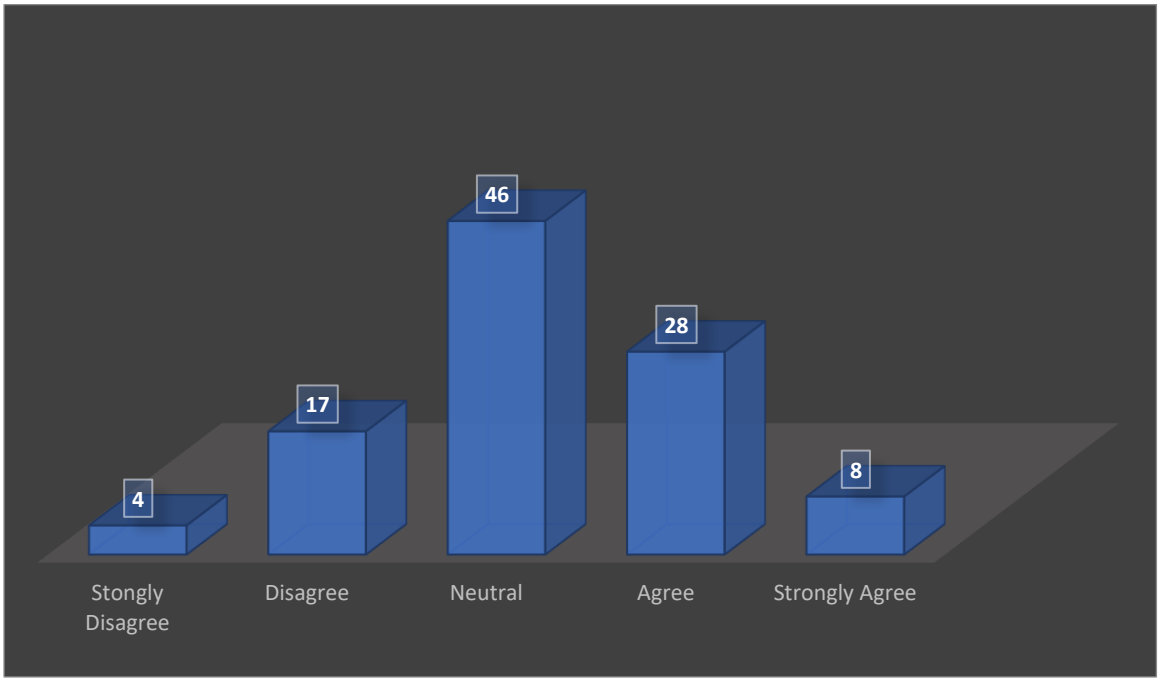
Bifurcations of the table in charts:

Chart No. 11

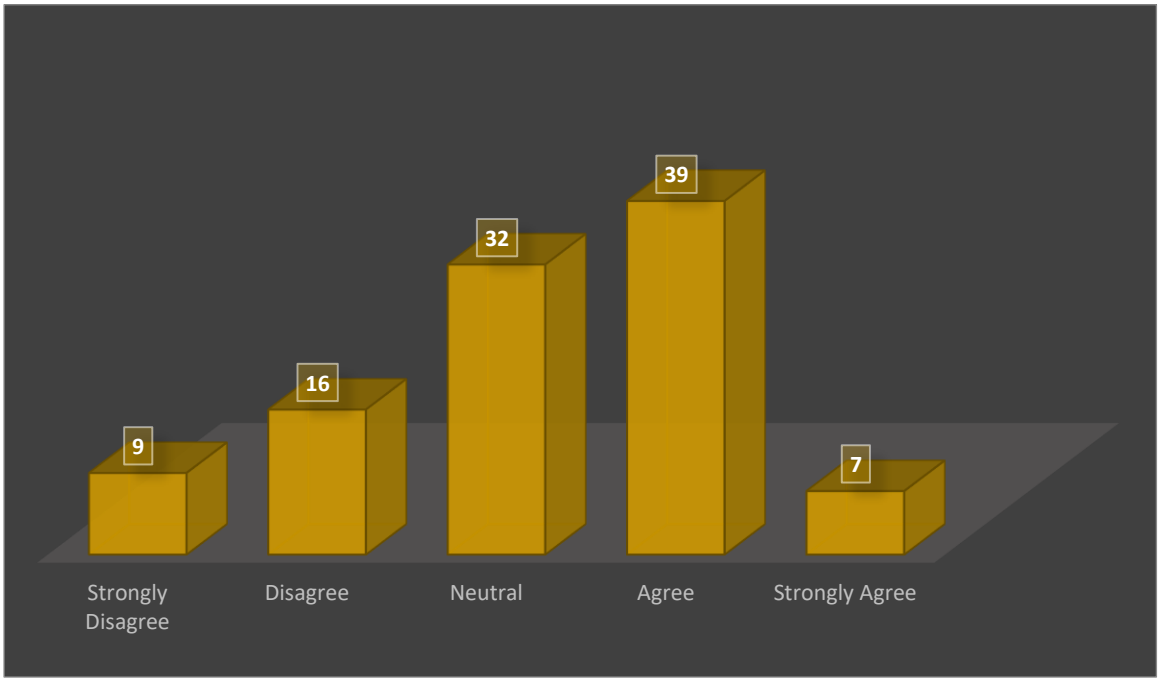
Q. The use of memes, trends, or viral content in marketing campaigns influences my decision to engage with a game. (Chart No. 11)



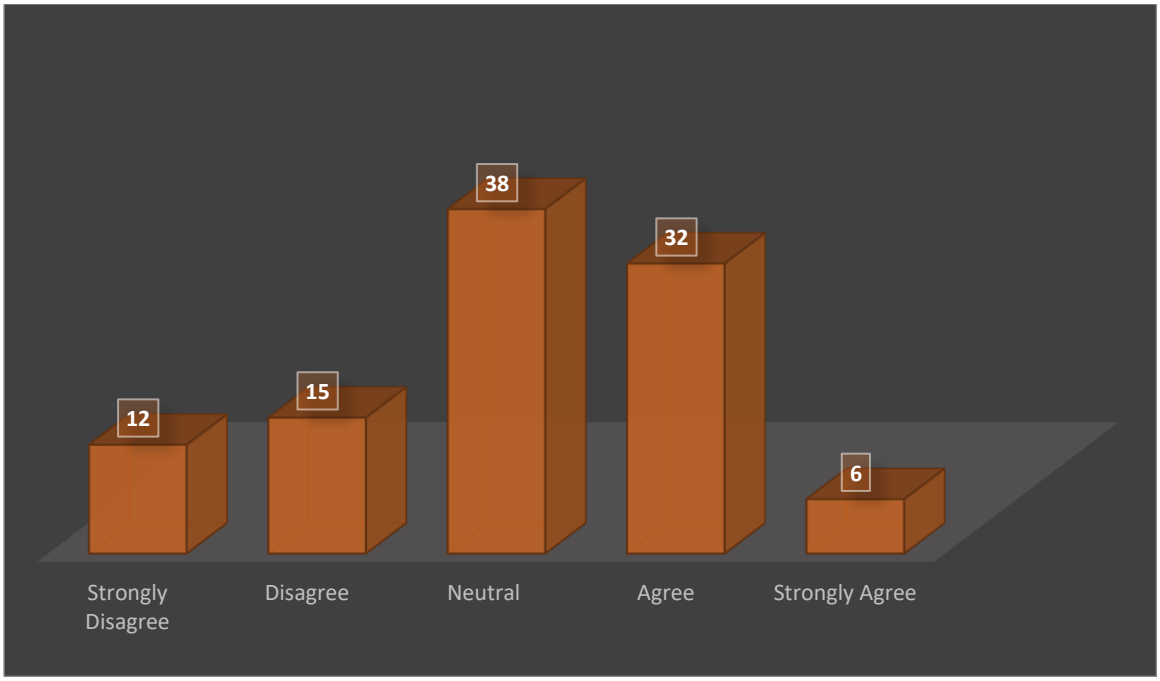
Q. I have noticed a positive change in my gaming preferences due to targeted marketing campaigns. (Chart No. 12)



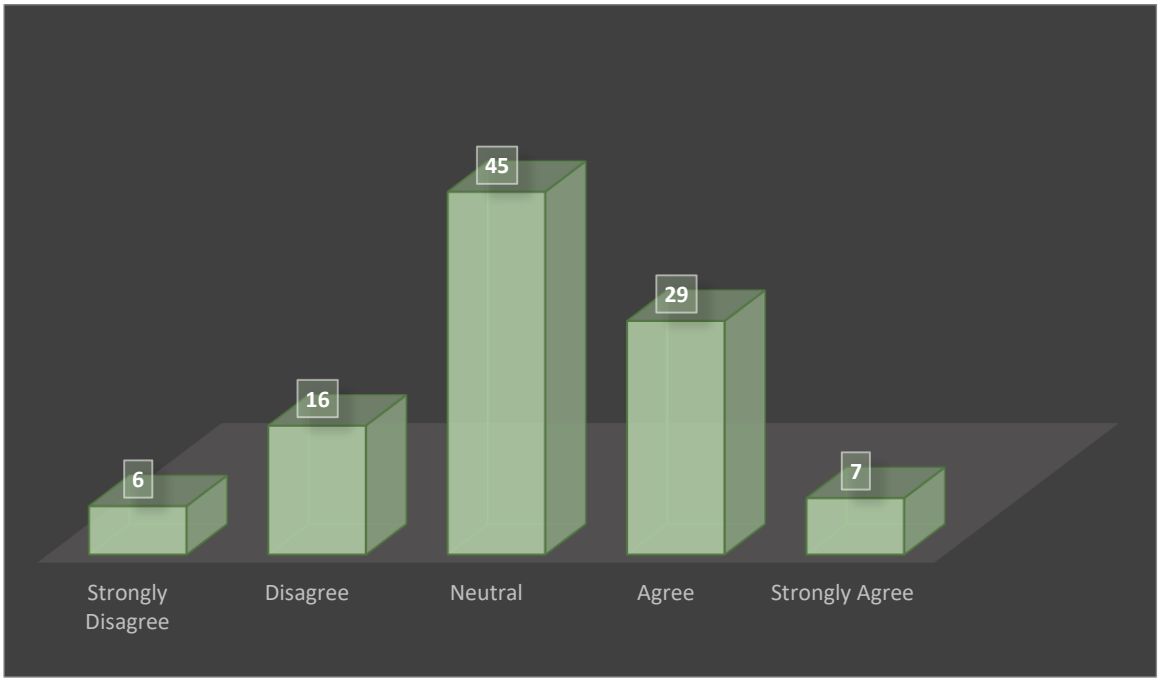
Q. I often purchase games or in-game purchases(microtransactions) based on marketing that resonates with my interests and personality. (Chart No. 13)



Q. I feel more inclined to try a game if the advertisement or campaign features a popular social media influencer or celebrity. (Chart No. 14)



Q. Selective marketing campaigns often make me feel more connected to a gaming community or culture. (Chart No. 15)



Interpretation:

From the above charts and table, it is evident that selective marketing strategies have a noticeable impact on gaming behavior. A significant portion of respondents (56%) agree and 13% strongly agree that the use of memes, trends, or viral content in marketing campaigns influences their decision to engage with a game, indicating that popular culture and social trends play a key role in attracting gamers.

In terms of targeted marketing, 46% of participants are neutral, while 28% agree that they have noticed a change in their gaming preferences due to these campaigns, suggesting that while targeted marketing has an effect, it may not be universally compelling. Additionally, 39% of gamers often purchase games or in-game purchases based on marketing that resonates with their interests, highlighting the importance of personalization in game advertising. The influence of social media influencers or celebrities is also notable, as 32% of respondents feel more inclined to try a game if such figures are featured in campaigns. Finally, 29% agree that selective marketing campaigns make them feel more connected to the gaming community, pointing to the role of marketing in fostering a sense of belonging among players. Overall, these results suggest that selective marketing strategies, particularly those that leverage trends and influencers, are impactful in shaping gaming preferences and decisions.

Section 6: Social Influence:

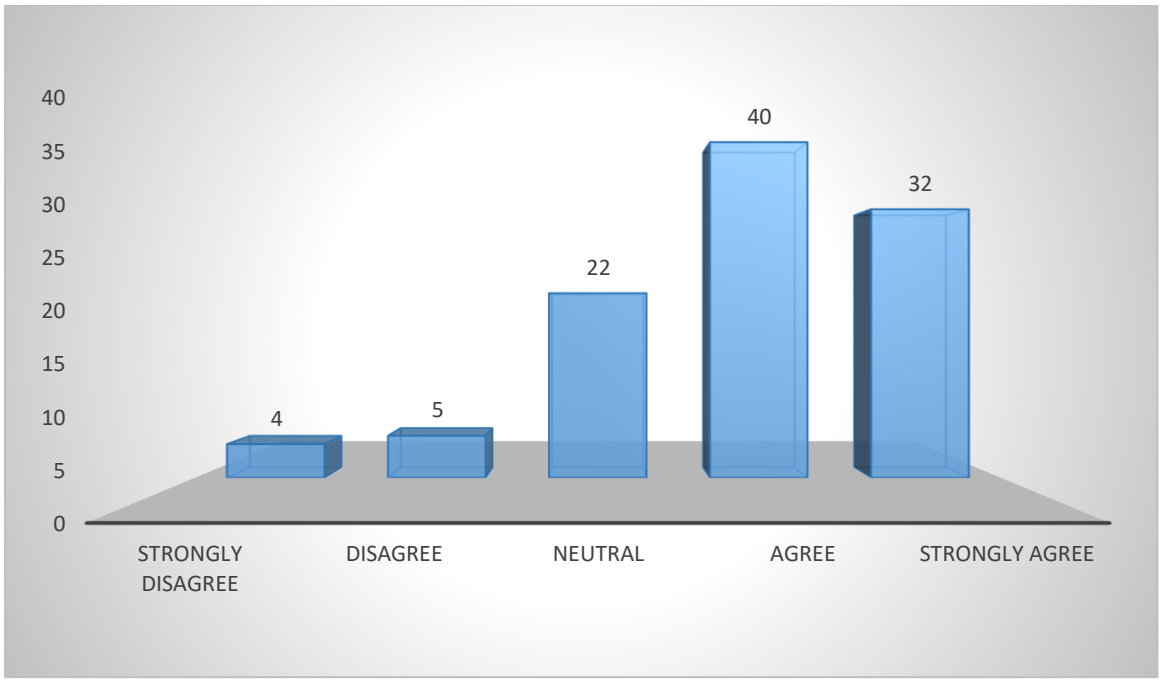
Table No. 23

Questions	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly Agree
1. I feel like my friends and peers influence my gaming choices more than advertisements do.	4	5	22	40	32
2. Selective marketing in the gaming industry encourages me to compare my gaming habits and purchases with those of others.	3	10	47	37	6
3. I often see people around me playing games or discussing games that were heavily marketed to my demographic.	3	8	38	37	17
4. I feel that targeted marketing in gaming has made certain games more "socially acceptable" to play within my peer group.	2	11	31	36	23

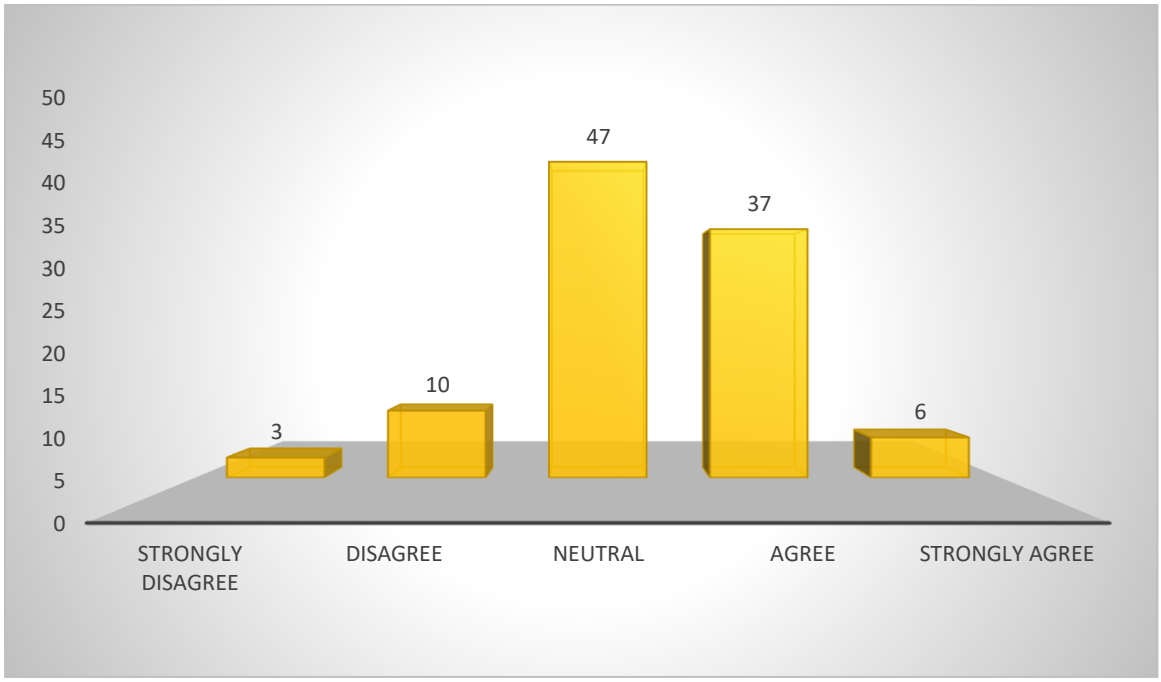
Bifurcations of the table in charts:

Chart No. 12

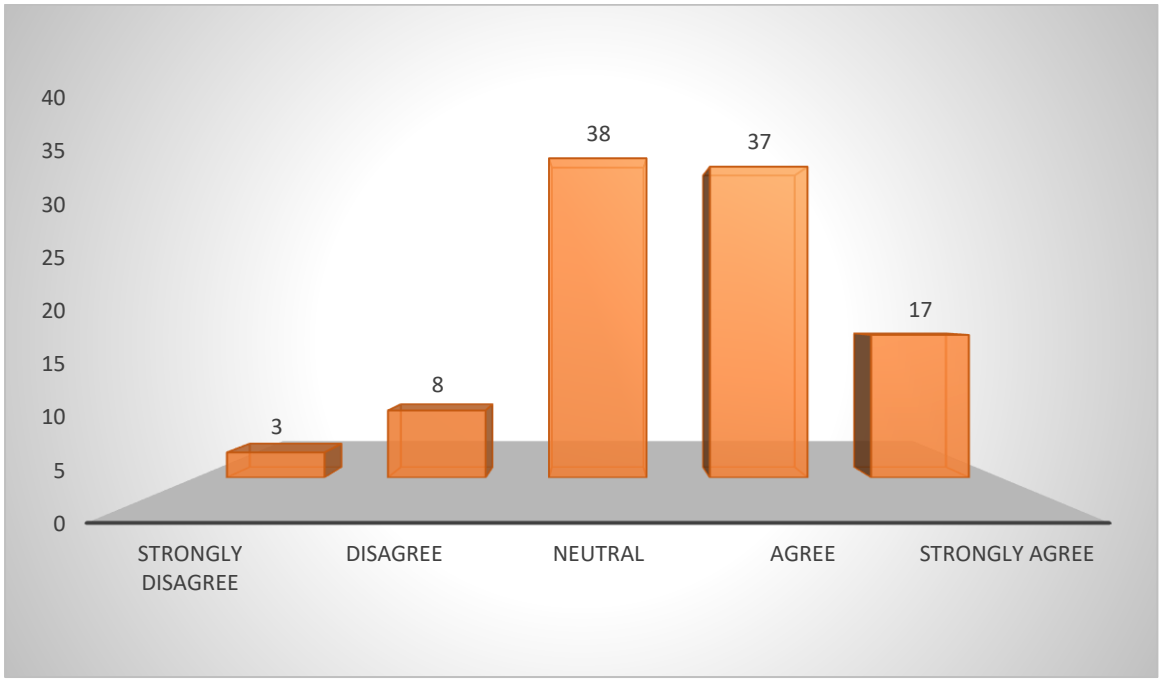
Q. I feel like my friends and peers influence my gaming choices more than advertisements do. (Chart No. 12.1)



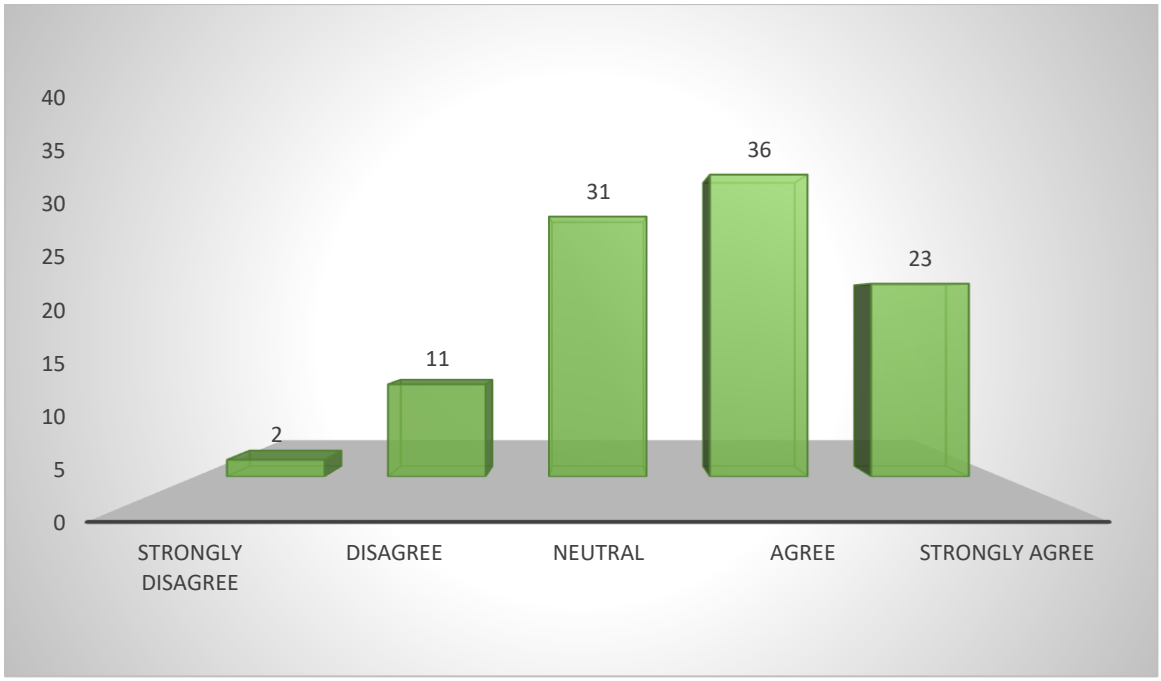
Q. Selective marketing in the gaming industry encourages me to compare my gaming habits and purchases with those of others. (Chart No. 12.2)



Q. I often see people around me playing games or discussing games that were heavily marketed to my demographic. (Chart No. 12.3)



Q. I feel that targeted marketing in gaming has made certain games more "socially acceptable" to play within my peer group. (Chart No. 12.4)



Interpretation:

From the above table and charts, the survey responses reveal how peer influence and selective marketing intersect in shaping gaming behavior. A significant number of respondents (72%) agree or strongly agree that their friends and peers influence their gaming choices more than advertisements, indicating that social factors play a critical role in decision-making within the gaming community.

In terms of selective marketing, 47% of participants are neutral about being encouraged to compare their gaming habits with others, while 43% agree or strongly agree, suggesting that marketing does sometimes foster a sense of comparison among gamers. Additionally, 54% of respondents have noticed people around them playing or discussing games that were heavily marketed to their demographic, pointing to the significant role of targeted campaigns in influencing social gaming trends.

Finally, 59% feel that targeted marketing has made certain games more socially acceptable within their peer groups, highlighting the social influence of marketing in shaping gaming culture. These findings demonstrate that while advertisements are influential, peer and social group dynamics continue to heavily shape gaming choices and perceptions.

Mean Calculation:

Table No. 24

No.	Particulars	Total	Mean
1	I am satisfied with the gaming advertisements I see which are generally aligned with my personal preferences and gaming habits.	309	**2.97**
2	The personalization of gaming ads (based on my preferences) has a positive impact on my gaming experience.	292	**2.81**
3	I am satisfied with the current gaming experience on my preferred platform (e.g., PC, console, mobile).	283	**2.72**
4	The gaming ads I encounter online are relevant to my interests.	308	**2.96**
5	I see gaming ads specifically targeting my demographic (Gen Z).	297	**2.86**
6	Selective marketing influences my decision to buy a game(in a good or a bad way).	272	**2.62**
7	I support a game developer or publisher that engages in ethical marketing practices (e.g., honest advertising, no deceptive ads).	289	**2.78**
8	Personalized gaming franchises create a sense of excitement about new releases.	278	**2.67**
9	Targeted gaming franchises make me feel like my gaming experience is more personalized.	273	**2.63**
10	I try a game based on a developer's reputation, even if I've never heard of the game before?	268	**2.58**
11	Seeing gaming advertisements makes me feel more excited for new upcoming games.	295	**2.79**
12	The use of memes, trends, or viral content in marketing campaigns influences my decision to engage with a game.	371	**3.57**
13	I have noticed a positive change in my gaming preferences due to targeted marketing campaigns.	328	**3.15**

14	I often purchase games or in-game purchases(microtransactions) based on marketing that resonates with my interests and personality.	328	**3.15**
15	I feel more inclined to try a game if the advertisement or campaign features a popular social media influencer or celebrity.	314	**3.02**
16	Selective marketing campaigns often make me feel more connected to a gaming community or culture.	324	**3.12**
17	I feel like my friends and peers influence my gaming choices more than advertisements do.	400	**3.85**
18	Selective marketing in the gaming industry encourages me to compare my gaming habits and purchases with those of others.	342	**3.29**
19	I often see people around me playing games or discussing games that were heavily marketed to my demographic.	366	**3.52**
20	I feel that targeted marketing in gaming has made certain games more "socially acceptable" to play within my peer group.	376	**3.62**

Example of the above calculation:

In the survey,

- 1 – Very Dissatisfied, 2 – Dissatisfied, 3 – Neutral, 4 – Satisfied, 5 – Very Satisfied
- Mean = (5*1) + (26*2) + (40*3) + (28*4) + (4*5)

  = 309/104

  = 2.97

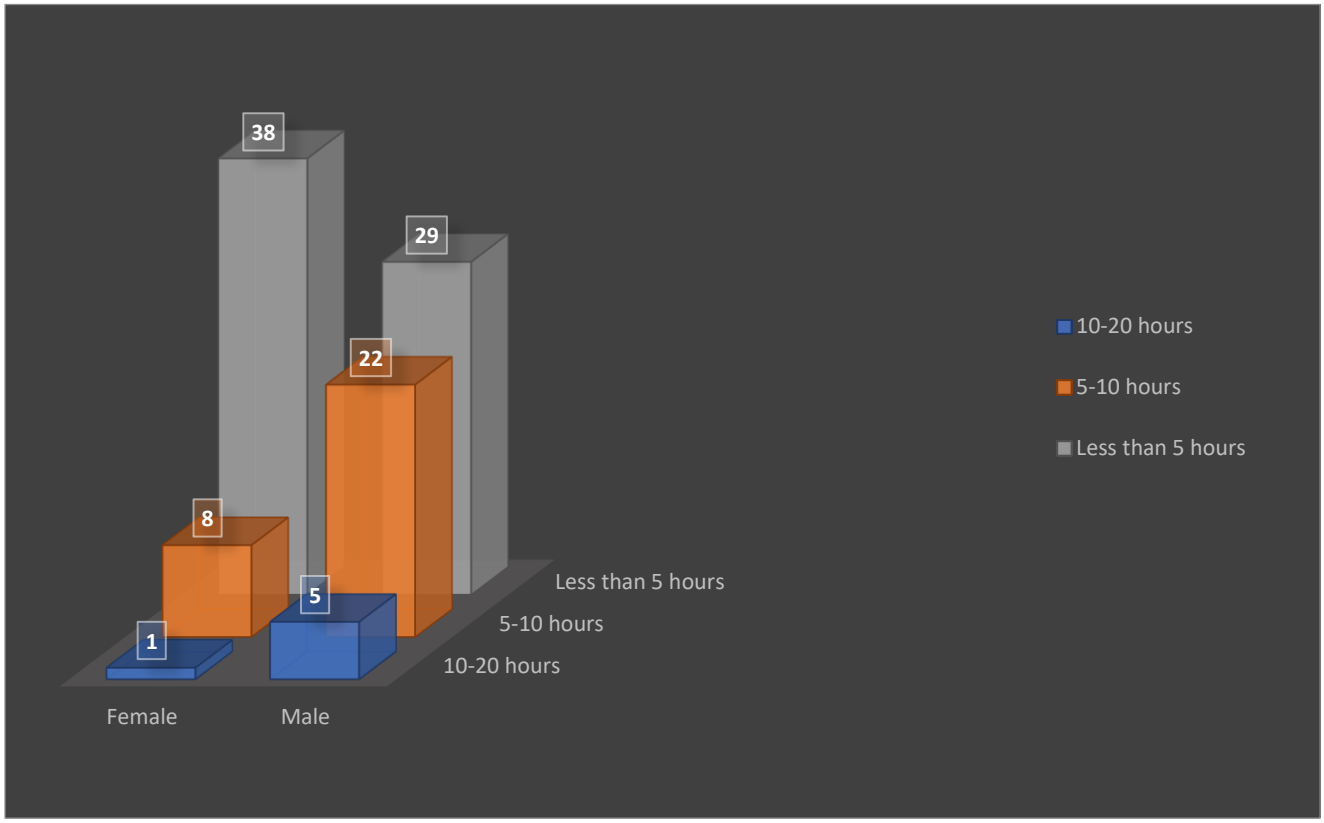
Here, 309 is the total of the calculation. 104 total respondents are there i.e. dividing it by the total gives the mean (2.97)

Objective 1: To study the relationship between gender and the amount of time spent gaming on a weekly basis.

Table No. 25

	Male	Female	Total
Less than 5 hours	29	38	67
5-10 hours	22	8	30
10-20 hours	5	1	6
20+ hours	0	0	0
Total	56	47	103

Chart No. 13



Interpretation:

The data reveals that the majority of respondents, both male and female, engage in gaming for less than 5 hours per week, with females slightly leading this category (38 compared to 29 males). This indicates that casual gaming is most common among the Gen Z demographic in Surat, with many spending minimal time on gaming each week. In contrast, males tend to spend more time gaming in the 5-10 hours range (22 males vs. 8 females), suggesting a slightly more consistent gaming habit among male players. However, the number of people gaming for 10-20 hours is quite low, with only a few individuals in this range, and no respondents reported gaming for over 20 hours a week.

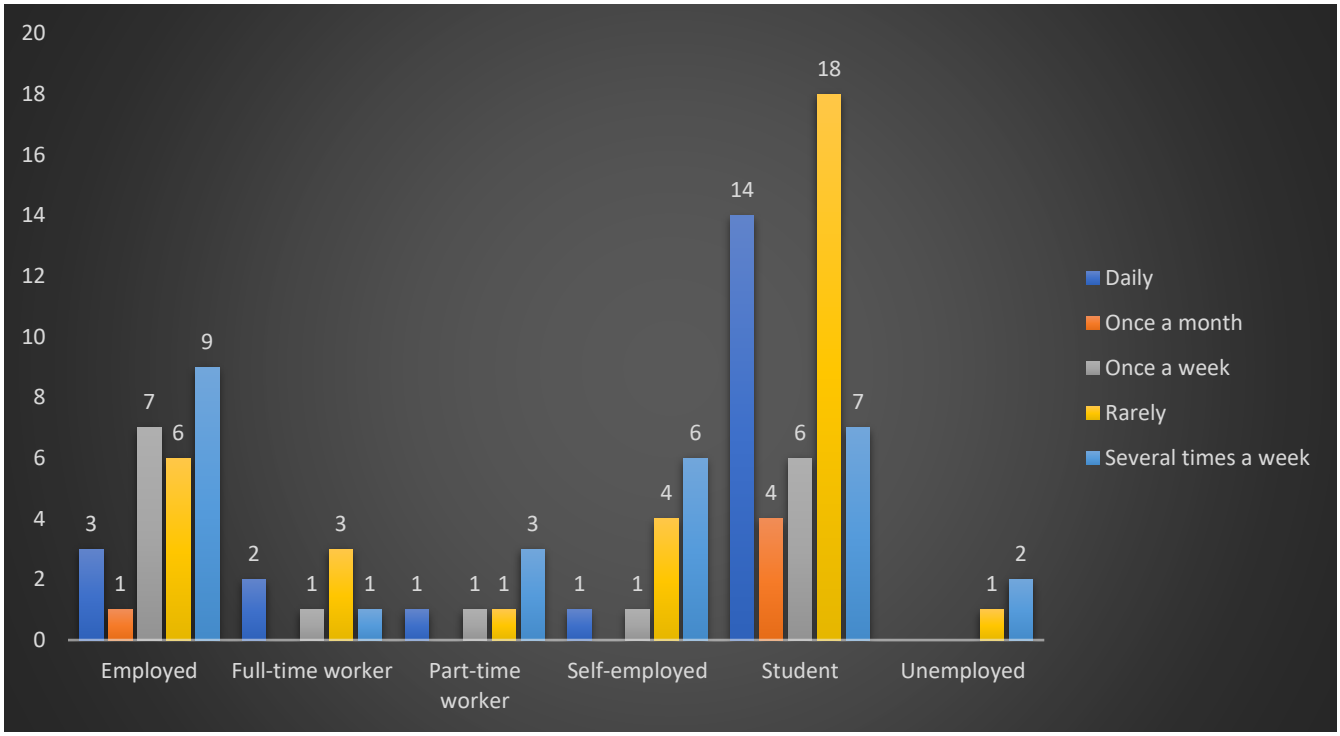
The overall trend in the data shows that most Gen Z gamers in Surat prefer shorter, more casual gaming sessions, with only a small portion dedicating more time to their gaming habits. The absence of respondents gaming for more than 20 hours suggests that the gaming culture in Surat is not overwhelmingly characterized by extreme engagement. Furthermore, the distribution of gaming hours shows that while males' game slightly more than females, the difference is not significant enough to suggest a major gender divide in gaming time. This data highlights that while gaming is a popular pastime among Gen Z, the time spent on it is generally moderate, reflecting a balanced engagement with gaming alongside other activities.

Objective 2: To analyze how an individual's occupation influences the frequency of their gaming patterns.

Table No. 26

	Daily	Several times a week	Once a week	Once a month	Rarely	Total
Student	14	7	6	4	18	49
Part-time worker	1	3	1	0	1	6
Full-time worker	2	1	1	0	3	7
Self-employed	1	6	1	0	4	12
Employed	3	9	7	1	6	26
Unemployed	0	2	0	0	1	3
Total	21	28	16	5	33	103

Chart No. 14



Interpretation:

The data reveals that individuals aged 15-25 are the most active group in terms of gaming frequency, with a significant number of them playing daily and several times a week. Within this age group, males engage in daily gaming more frequently, with 8 occurrences, while females are more likely to game once a week or less. Interestingly, the 26-35 age group shows a considerable drop in gaming frequency, with most individuals playing rarely or several times a week. The group aged 35 or above has the least participation, with only a few individuals engaging in gaming on rare occasions. The data highlights a clear trend where younger age groups, particularly 15-25, exhibit a higher inclination toward daily gaming and frequent engagement compared to older age groups.

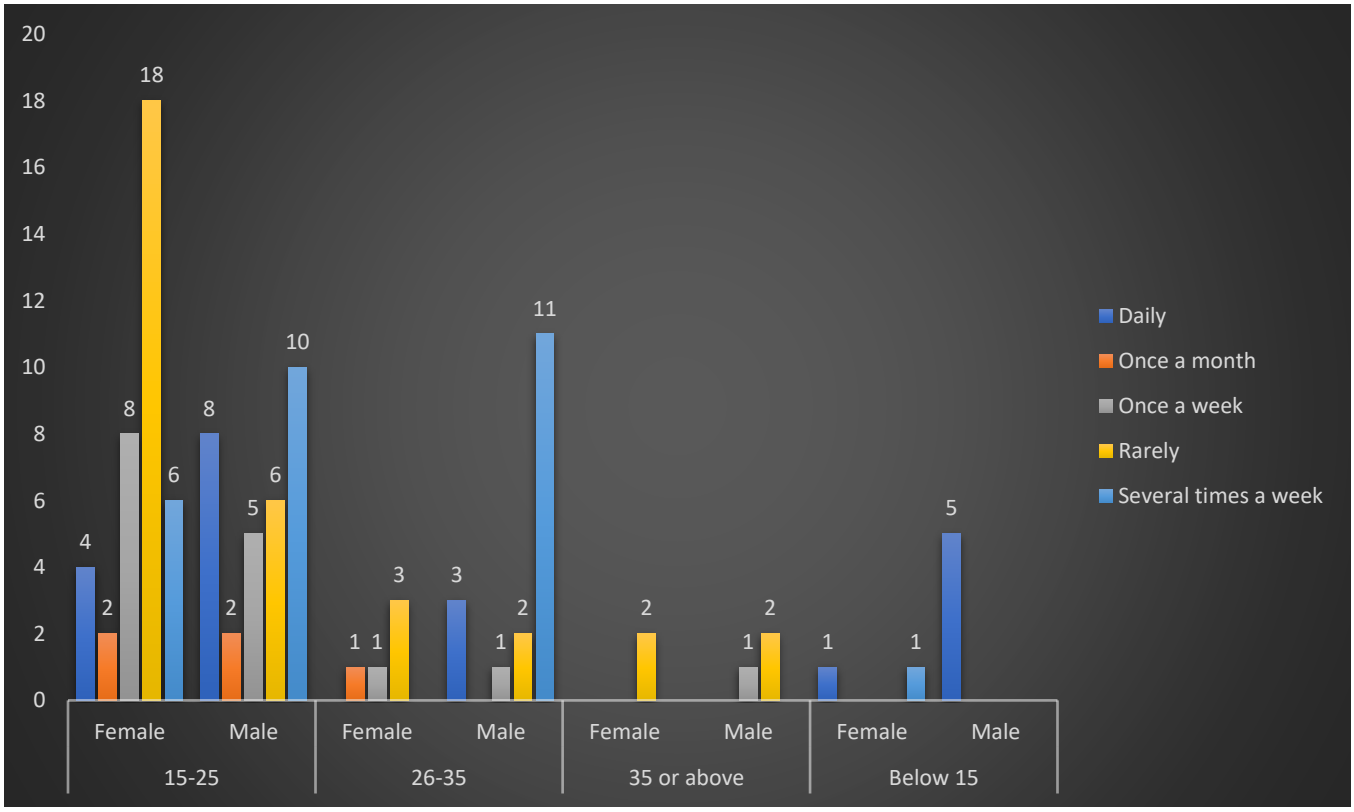
Gender differences are evident across the age groups, as males consistently report higher gaming frequencies compared to females. In the 15-25 age group, males dominate daily gaming habits, while females lean toward weekly or rare play. Females across all age groups tend to engage in gaming less frequently, with many opting for once a month or rarely, indicating a more moderate approach to gaming. In contrast, males in the same age groups play on a more regular basis, with the 15-25 age group again showing the highest frequency of engagement. These trends suggest that while both males and females enjoy gaming, males, especially younger ones, tend to be more consistent in their gaming routines.

Objective 3: To examine the correlation between gamers' age, gender, and the frequency of their gaming habits.

Table No. 27

	Daily	Once a month	Once a week	Rarely	Several times a week	Grand Total
15-25	**12**	**4**	**13**	**24**	**16**	**69**
Female	4	2	8	18	6	38
Male	8	2	5	6	10	31
26-35	**3**	**1**	**2**	**5**	**11**	**22**
Female		1	1	3		5
Male	3		1	2	11	17
35 or above			**1**	**4**		**5**
Female				2		2
Male			1	2		3
Below 15	**6**				**1**	**7**
Female	1				1	2
Male	5					5
Grand Total	**21**	**5**	**16**	**33**	**28**	**103**

Chart No. 15



Interpretation:

Based on the data provided, the frequency of gaming habits shows a strong pattern among individuals aged 15-25, particularly for daily and weekly gaming. In this age group, males and females play regularly, with males playing daily (8 occurrences) and females playing weekly (13 occurrences). However, those aged 26-35 and above 35 show much less engagement, with the majority playing either rarely or several times a week. Notably, the youngest group (below 15) also participates in gaming, though less frequently, with males in this category mostly playing on a daily basis.

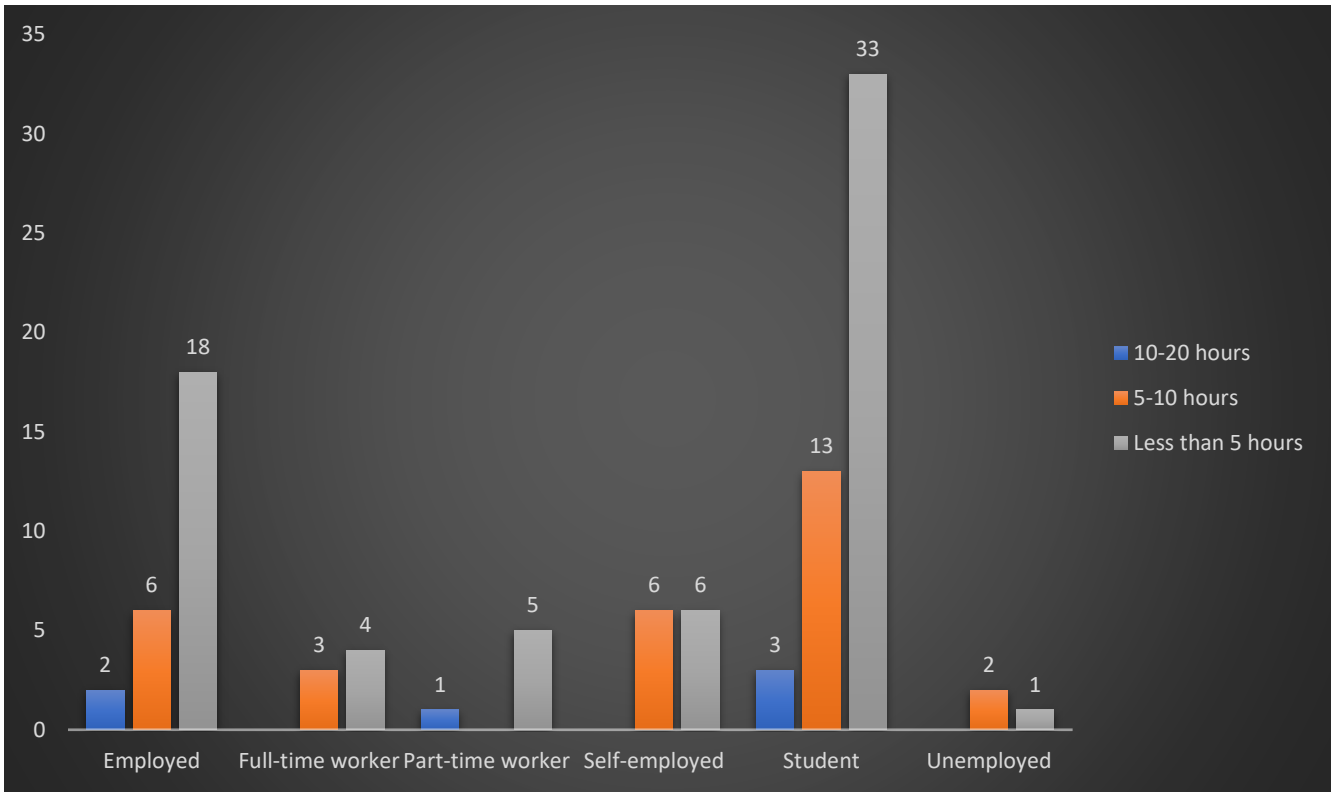
In terms of gender, a higher proportion of males across all age groups are gaming on a daily basis or several times a week, particularly within the 15-25 and 26-35 age ranges. Females show a more varied pattern, with more instances of playing rarely or once a month, especially in the 15-25 age group. The overall trend indicates that daily gaming and playing several times a week are more common in younger males, while females exhibit less frequent but consistent gaming activity. This information can provide valuable insights into the gaming preferences and habits of different demographic segments.

Objective 4: To examine the correlation between an individual's occupation and the amount of time they spend on gaming.

Table No. 28

	Less than 5 hours	5-10 hours	10-20 hours	20+ hours	Total
Student	33	13	3	0	49
Part-time worker	5	0	1	0	6
Full-time worker	4	3	0	0	7
Self-employed	6	6	0	0	12
Employed	18	6	2	0	26
Unemployed	1	2	0	0	3
Grand Total	**67**	**30**	**6**	**0**	**104**

Chart No. 16



Interpretation:

The data presents the relationship between an individual's occupation and the amount of time spent on gaming. Students are the most active group, with the majority gaming for less than 5 hours, totalling 33 individuals. A smaller portion of students game for 5-10 hours, but no students report gaming for over 20 hours a week. In contrast, part-time workers, full-time workers, and the unemployed spend far less time on gaming, with most reporting fewer than 5 hours per week. This trend highlights the significant difference in gaming habits between students and other occupational groups, likely due to students having more free time compared to those with employment commitments.

Among other groups, self-employed individuals report the highest number of hours spent on gaming (6 for less than 5 hours, and 6 for 5-10 hours), while full-time workers and part-time workers show minimal gaming engagement, with the majority spending less than 5 hours. The employed group also tends to game in moderation, with most individuals spending fewer than 5 hours weekly. Interestingly, the unemployed group shows limited gaming activity, with only a small number gaming less than 5 hours per week. Overall, the data suggests that occupation significantly impacts the time dedicated to gaming, with students leading in gaming hours, and employed or unemployed individuals gaming far less frequently.

5.2 Findings:

- The study explores the relationship between gender and the amount of time spent gaming per week.
- A significant portion of both male and female respondents reported gaming for less than 5 hours per week (65.4% of respondents).
- A higher percentage of male respondents (52.3%) spend more time gaming compared to females (47.7%).
- Among male participants, 28.8% report gaming for 5-10 hours per week, indicating more consistent engagement with gaming.
- Male respondents also tend to engage in gaming for longer durations, with some indicating they game more than 10 hours weekly.
- Female respondents, in contrast, reported shorter gaming sessions, with 88.5% spending fewer than 10 hours gaming per week.
- Only 11.5% of female participants spent 5-10 hours gaming weekly.
- The majority of female gamers (65.4%) reported gaming for less than 5 hours each week.
- A lower percentage of females reported spending more time gaming, with no female respondents indicating gaming for 20+ hours weekly.
- The male respondents showed a greater inclination toward gaming platforms such as PCs and consoles, which are typically associated with longer and more immersive gaming sessions.
- Female respondents preferred mobile gaming (45%) more than males, which could contribute to shorter gaming times.
- The overall data suggests that male gamers are more likely to engage in regular and extended gaming sessions than female gamers.
- Despite spending less time gaming, female respondents still showed strong interest in gaming content and experiences.

- These differences in gaming time could be influenced by external factors like social norms, responsibilities, or accessibility to gaming platforms.
- The study suggests that gender-based preferences may also affect gaming habits, with male gamers being more likely to engage with high-end gaming platforms, while females prefer more accessible options.
- The higher gaming time reported by males could be linked to a greater preference for multiplayer, competitive, or expansive gaming experiences.
- The study also indicates that both genders exhibit similar levels of satisfaction with gaming advertisements and marketing strategies.
- Although males tend to game more, females show comparable interest in the same types of games, suggesting that engagement might not be solely determined by time spent gaming.
- These findings can inform targeted marketing strategies within the gaming industry, ensuring that both genders receive content tailored to their unique gaming habits and preferences.
- In conclusion, the study emphasizes the importance of understanding gender differences in gaming behaviors, as this can lead to more effective marketing and game development strategies.

Chapter 6:

Conclusion & Suggestions

6.1 Conclusion:

- This study explored the impact and consequences of selective marketing on Gen Z's gaming habits in Surat, focusing on how personalized marketing campaigns influence gaming preferences, purchasing decisions, and social engagement.
- The research utilized both quantitative and qualitative methods to understand how selective marketing, including the use of viral content, influencers, and peer influence, shapes the gaming experience for Gen Z.
- The findings reveal that personalization and selective marketing play a significant role in how Gen Z engages with gaming content, although the impact varies across individuals.
- While memes, trends, and viral content proved effective in drawing attention, the influence of peers and social groups outweighed traditional advertising in shaping gaming choices. Gen Z respondents were more likely to be influenced by recommendations from friends and social interactions than by advertisements themselves, highlighting the importance of word-of-mouth marketing and social proof in the gaming industry.
- Additionally, targeted marketing has the potential to foster a sense of belonging to the gaming community, making games more socially accepted and creating stronger connections between players and gaming cultures.
- However, the data also indicated that not all marketing strategies had a uniform impact. While influencers and celebrities had a moderate effect on some individuals, others were indifferent, suggesting that not all segments of Gen Z respond similarly to influencer-driven campaigns.
- Social media-driven content and the use of viral trends were, however, effective tools for many respondents, demonstrating the importance of tapping into current cultural moments to capture attention.
- Moreover, ethical marketing was seen as important by a portion of respondents, but it wasn't a top priority for the majority. This suggests that while honesty and transparency in marketing resonate with some, many Gen Z consumers prioritize engagement and relevance over the ethical stance of game developers.
- The Cyberpunk 2077 story within the report further illustrates the consequences of selective marketing when expectations are not met. The game's initial marketing campaign created massive hype with highly selective ads aimed at appealing to the futuristic, dystopian themes beloved by a wide Gen Z audience.

- However, the product's delayed launch and the disconnect between the marketing promises and the actual game experience led to significant backlash. This case highlights the need for marketing strategies to be authentic, ensuring that the experience matches what is advertised to avoid consumer disappointment and potential long-term damage to a brand's reputation.
- In conclusion, the gaming industry's marketing strategies aimed at Gen Z in Surat need to focus on community-building, peer influence, and relevance to current trends while ensuring authenticity in their messaging.
- The findings suggest that selective marketing, when done right, can significantly enhance user engagement, but marketers must be mindful of the diverse reactions within the Gen Z demographic.
- Moving forward, gaming companies should refine their strategies to strike a balance between personalization, social proof, and ethical considerations to effectively capture and retain the attention of Gen Z gamers.

6.2 Future Scope:

This study opens several avenues for future research:

1. **Impact of Emerging Technologies**: Investigating how VR, AR, and AI can enhance personalized marketing in gaming for Gen Z.
2. **Cross-Cultural Differences**: Exploring how selective marketing affects Gen Z gamers in different regions, both within India and globally.
3. **Long-Term Brand Loyalty**: Understanding how personalized marketing influences sustained brand loyalty among Gen Z gamers.
4. **Social Media and Community Campaigns**: Analyzing how user-generated content and social media trends shape gaming choices.
5. **Ethical Marketing**: Researching the growing importance of ethical marketing practices and their effect on Gen Z's gaming decisions.
6. **Paid vs. Organic Marketing**: Comparing the effectiveness of paid advertising versus organic, peer-influenced marketing.
7. **Gamification of Marketing**: Exploring how game-like elements in marketing campaigns drive engagement and purchasing decisions.
8. **Esports and Live Streaming**: Examining how esports and live streaming platforms impact selective marketing strategies for gaming.
9. **Psychological Effects of Selective Marketing:** Exploring how selective marketing impacts the psychological motivations and emotional responses of Gen Z gamers, including feelings of identity formation and self-expression through gaming.
10. **Influence of Microtransactions and In-Game Purchases:** Researching how targeted marketing affects spending behavior on in-game purchases, especially regarding microtransactions and loot boxes, which have been controversial among players.
11. **Marketing Strategies in Different Game Genres:** Investigating how selective marketing strategies differ across various game genres (e.g., RPGs, shooters, MOBAs) and how Gen Z's preferences vary by genre.

12. **Impact of Influencer-Driven Marketing:** Studying the long-term effectiveness of influencer partnerships in gaming marketing campaigns, particularly in terms of credibility and trust built with Gen Z audiences.
13. **Impact of Subscription Models and Digital Distribution:** Analyzing how marketing strategies for subscription-based services (e.g., Xbox Game Pass, PlayStation Plus) influence Gen Z's gaming choices, compared to traditional purchase-based models.
14. **Augmented Reality (AR) in Mobile Gaming Marketing:** Understanding the role of AR technology in mobile game marketing and how it can enhance the gaming experience and engagement for Gen Z.
15. **Effectiveness of Interactive Ads and Gamified Campaigns**: Examining how interactive advertisements and gamified marketing campaigns (such as in-game challenges or competitions) influence Gen Z's engagement with games.

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6.5 Annexure:

Questionnaire:

Survey on the Impact and Consequences of Selective Marketing on Gen Z for the Gaming Industry in Surat City

Introduction:

Thank you for participating in this survey! This research aims to understand how selective marketing strategies in the gaming industry affects the gaming preferences and behaviours of Gen Z (individuals aged 18-30) in Surat city. Your responses will help us gain valuable insights into how targeted marketing influences gaming choices and experiences.

The survey is anonymous, and all answers will be kept confidential.

Please take your time to answer the following questions based on your experiences.

Section 1 : Demographic information:

6. Name : _____

7. Birth year: _____

8. What is your age?
   - Below 15
   - 15 – 25
   - 25 – 35
   - Above 35

9. What is your gender?
   - Male
   - Female
   - Non-binary
   - Rather Not Say

10. What is your occupation?
    - Student
    - Part-time worker
    - Full-time worker
    - Self-Employed
    - Employed
    - Unemployed

Section 2: Gaming Habits:

Questions	**Categories**
1. How often do you play video games?	[ ] Daily [ ] Several times a week [ ] Once a week [ ] Once a month [ ] Rarely
2. What is your primary gaming platform?	[ ] PC [ ] Console (XBOX, PlayStation, etc.) [ ] Mobile [ ] VR Headset [ ] Other:_____

3. How many hours do you typically spend gaming per week?	[ ] Less than 5 hours [ ] 5-10 hours [ ] 10-20 hours [ ] 20+ hours
4. How do you usually play video games?	[ ] Alone [ ] With friends/family in person [ ] Online with friends or strangers [ ] Co-op multiplayer [ ] Other:_____
5. Which genre of games do you prefer to play?	[ ] Role-Playing Games (RPG) [ ] MMOs [ ] Narrative driven games [ ] FPS (First Person Shooter) [ ] Other

Further, in this survey, you'll rate each statement on a 5-point scale, from "Strongly Agree" or "Very Satisfied" to "Strongly Disagree" or "Very Dissatisfied." Choose the option that best matches your opinion or experience.

Section 3: Marketing Exposure:

Questions	Very Dis-satisfied	Dis-satisfied	Neutral	Satisfied	Very Satisfied
6. The gaming advertisements I see are generally aligned with my personal preferences and gaming habits.					
7. The personalization of gaming ads (based on my preferences) has a positive impact on my gaming experience.					
8. I am satisfied with the current gaming experience on my preferred platform (e.g., PC, console, mobile).					
9. The gaming ads I encounter online are relevant to my interests.					
10. I see gaming ads specifically targeting my demographic (Gen Z).					

Section 4: Brand and Product Perception:

Questions	Very Likely	Likely	Neutral	Unlikely	Very Unlikely
11. Selective marketing influences my decision to buy a game (in a good or a bad way).					
12. I support a game developer or publisher that engages in ethical marketing practices (e.g., honest advertising, no deceptive ads).					
13. Personalized gaming franchises create a sense of excitement about new releases.					
14. Targeted gaming franchises make me feel like my gaming experience is more personalized.					
15. I try a game based on a developer's reputation, even if I've never heard of the game before?					
16. Seeing gaming advertisements makes me feel more excited for new upcoming games.					

Section 5: Impact on Gaming Choices and Behaviour:

Questions	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly Agree
17. The use of memes, trends, or viral content in marketing campaigns influences my decision to engage with a game.					
18. I have noticed a positive change in my gaming preferences due to targeted marketing campaigns.					
19. I often purchase games or in-game purchases (microtransactions) based on marketing that resonates with my interests and personality.					
20. I feel more inclined to try a game if the advertisement or campaign features a popular social media influencer or celebrity.					
21. Selective marketing campaigns often make me feel more connected to a gaming community or culture.					

Section 6: Social Influence:

Questions	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly Agree
22. I feel like my friends and peers influence my gaming choices more than advertisements do.					
23. Selective marketing in the gaming industry encourages me to compare my gaming habits and purchases with those of others.					
24. I often see people around me playing games or discussing games that were heavily marketed to my demographic.					
25. I feel that targeted marketing in gaming has made certain games more "socially acceptable" to play within my peer group.					